

A HELICOPTER-UFO ENCOUNTER OVER OHIO

by
Jennie Zeidman

Center for UFO Studies



"...and the thing was right there in front of us. I could see it very clearly."
Capt. Coyne

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Edited by Mimi Hynek and Sanna Hans Longden

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ABSTRACT

On October 18, 1973 at approximately 11:00 pm, a helicopter of the U.S. Army Reserve was enroute from Columbus, Ohio to Cleveland, Ohio. Seven miles ESE of the Mansfield, Ohio airport, at an estimated altitude of 700 feet above ground, the crew encountered an unidentified lighted object. Analysis of the witness testimony indicates an uninterrupted observational time of approximately 300 seconds (± 30). During that time, radio communications were interrupted, instrument and control irregularities were noted, and the aircraft experienced a climb of approximately 1800 feet for which the pilot disclaims responsibility.

This report details interrogation of each of the four crew members, and five witnesses on the ground who were apparently within 1000 feet of the event. Possible explanations of either a meteor or a high-performance aircraft are explored and rejected. Supplementary material briefly discusses similar UFO reports from the same vicinity during the same evening, and a survey of other reports of apparent close encounters between UFOs and aircraft, involving possible electromagnetic anomalies.

Jennie Zeidman's involvement with the UFO phenomenon began in 1953 when, as a research assistant in the Department of Astronomy at Ohio State University, she worked with Dr. J. Allen Hynek and was technical assistant in his early years as a Project Blue Book consultant. Since then she has investigated many UFO sightings, including those of the Lumberton, North Carolina, area in 1975. Because of her background in aviation and astronomy, and her residence in Central Ohio, she was asked in 1976 by the Center for UFO Studies to pursue the investigation of the UFO encounter experienced by Captain Coyne and his crew.

By the Same Author

1. The Lumberton Report. Center for UFO Studies Technical Report, November 3, 1976.
2. "UFO-Helicopter Close Encounter Over Ohio." FSR, Vol. 22, No. 4, November, 1976.
3. "More on the Coyne Case." FSR, Vol. 23, No. 4, January 1978.
4. "Major Coyne and the UFO--The True Story." FATE Magazine, Vol. 31, No. 8, August 1978.
5. "Zeidman on Klass on Coyne." FATE Magazine, Vol. 31, No. 12, December 1978.

INTRODUCTION

The encounter between a military helicopter and an unknown object in the sky near Mansfield, Ohio on the night of October 18, 1973 has been of continued interest, not only because of the possible danger of the incident (a collision appeared imminent), but because of the technical competence and credibility of the four airmen witnesses. Dr. J. Allen Hynek, Director of the Center for UFO Studies, and I have both interviewed each of the crew members separately and together over a period of several years.

Subsequently, five apparent ground witnesses to the event have been located by UFO researchers Warren Nicholson and William E. Jones. I also interviewed these ground witnesses and spent many hours reviewing the tapes and reconstructing the dynamics of the occurrence.

Over the year and a half that I worked with the aircrew, there was never any indication of collusion, hoax, or willful exaggeration. The first taped account of the event (by Sgt. John Healey on October 19, the day following the incident) does not conflict with later interviews with the others; minor discrepancies which appear throughout are as much to be expected as the variations in testimony of witnesses to, say, an automobile accident; they do not affect the final analysis or conclusions drawn in this report.

Dr. Hynek conducted the first interview with Capt. Coyne (now Lt. Col.); he worked also with Sgts. Healey and Yanacsek

and with FAA officials at Hopkins Field. Healey's dream sequence was taken from a tape he made with his cousin, Laura Gallagher. All of the other information, unless specifically noted, was obtained and analyzed through my own efforts, and the opinions expressed are solely my own.

A complete listing of the sources for this report will be found on page 107. Words or phrases underlined in the tape transcripts indicate actual emphasis in the voice of the speaker, not emphasis added editorially.

The crew members of the UH-1H helicopter were:

Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne. Capt. Coyne, 36 (at the time of the incident), was a full-time commander of the 316th Medivac Unit in the U.S. Army Reserve, rated as a fixed-wing, helicopter, and seaplane pilot. He had previously been a plainclothesman in the Cleveland Police Department, and had served in the Army Reserve for 19 years.

1st Lt. Arrigo (Rick) Jezzi. Lt. Jezzi, 26, the co-pilot, was a chemical engineer rated for helicopter flying only. This was his first flight with Coyne and the others.

Sgt. John Healey. Sgt. Healey, 35, the flight medic, was a detective in the Intelligence Unit of the Cleveland Police Department with seven year police experience.

Spec. 5 Robert Yanacsek. Sgt. Yanacsek, 23, the crew chief, was an IBM service representative who had seen active duty in Viet Nam as a helicopter crew chief.

SUMMARY OF EVENTS REPORTED BY CREW

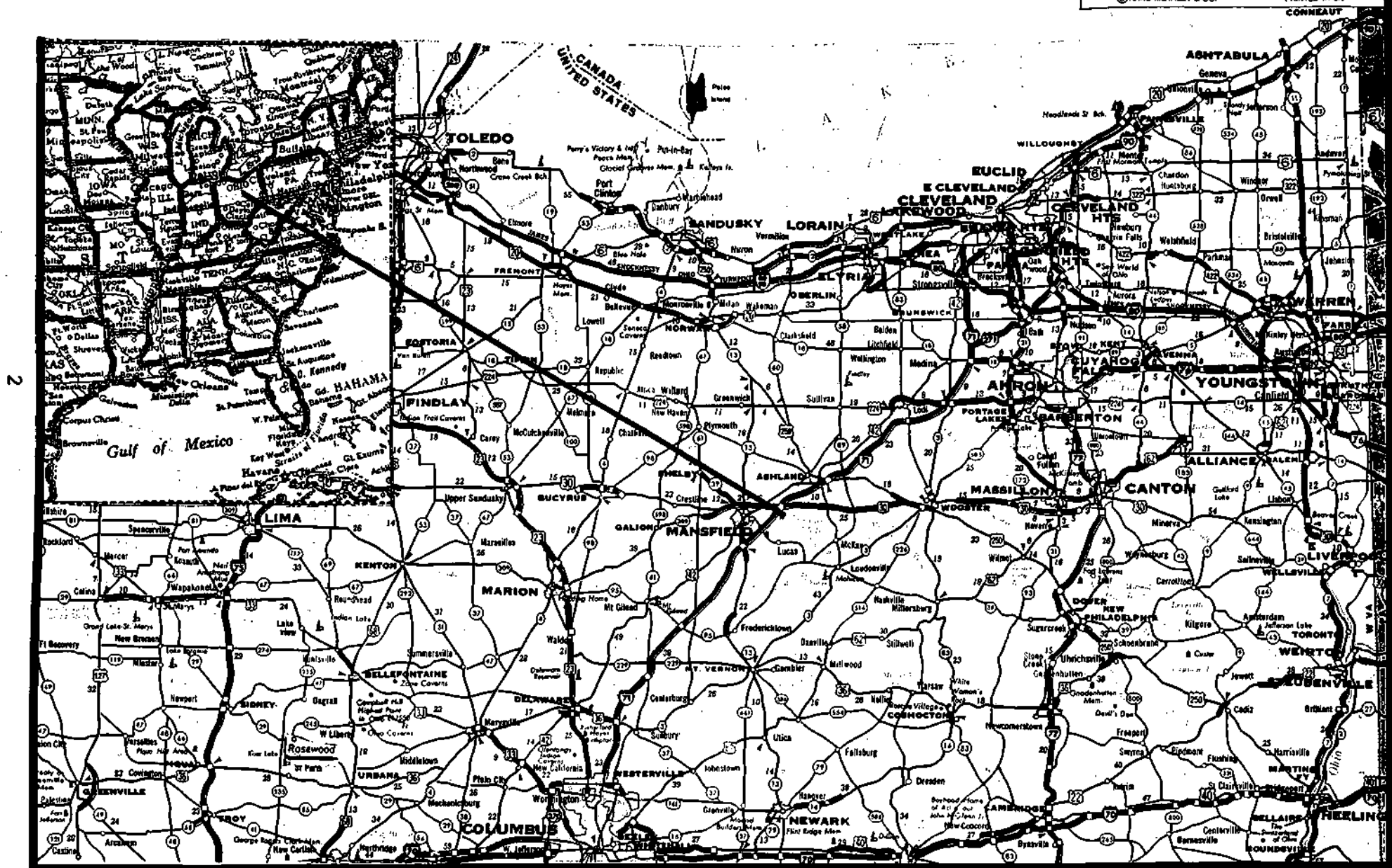
October 18, 1973: The four-man crew of an Army Reserve helicopter, based in Cleveland, Ohio, flew to Columbus for regularly scheduled physical exams. When finished, they left the medical facility at approximately 10:00 pm, drove back to the airport (a distance of two miles), filed a flight plan, and took off at approximately 10:30 pm.

The night was clear, calm, starry, and moonless, the temperature 43°F., visibility 15 miles. Lt. Arrigo Jezzi was flying from the left-hand seat. The helicopter was cruising at 90 knots (kts) at an altitude of 2500 feet mean sea level (msl) over mixed woods, farmland, and rolling hills averaging 1100 to 1200 feet elevation.

Near Mansfield, Ohio, Sgt. John Healey, in the left rear seat, saw a single red light off to the left (west) heading south. It seemed brighter than a portwing light of normal aircraft, but it was not relevant traffic, and he does not recall mentioning it.

At approximately 11:02 pm, an estimated three to four minutes after Healey's observation, Sgt. Robert Yanacsek, in the right rear seat, noticed a single steady red light on the eastern horizon. It appeared to be pacing the helicopter.

Figure 1
LOCATION OF SIGHTING



After watching it for perhaps a minute, he reported it to Capt. Lawrence Coyne, the aircraft commander, who instructed him to "keep an eye on it."

After approximately another 30 seconds, Yanacsek announced that the light appeared to be closing on their craft. Coyne and Yanacsek watched from their seats, Healey got up and stooped in the aisle to observe, Jezzi's view was obstructed.

The light continued its approach. Coyne grabbed the controls from Jezzi, began a powered descent of approximately 500 feet per minute (fpm), and almost simultaneously contacted Mansfield control tower, requesting information on possible jet traffic. After initial radio contact, the radios malfunctioned on both VHF and UHF.

The red light increased in intensity and appeared to be on a collision course at a speed estimated to be 600+ kts. Coyne increased the rate of descent to 2000 fpm. The last altitude he noted was 1700 feet msl.

As a collision appeared imminent, the light decelerated and assumed a hovering relationship above/in front of the helicopter. Coyne, Healey, and Yanacsek reported that a cigar-shaped gray metallic object filled the entire front windshield. A red light was at the nose, a white light at the tail, and a distinctive green beam emanated from the lower part of the object. The green beam swung up over the helicopter nose, through the main windshield, and into the upper tinted window panels, bathing the cockpit in green light. Jezzi reported only a white

light from the upper windows. No noise or turbulence from the object was noted.

After a few seconds of hovering, the light accelerated and moved off to the west, showing only the white "tail" light. Coyne and Healey reported that the object made a decisive 45° course change to the right. Jezzi did not observe the course change. Yanacsek's view was partially obstructed.

While the object was still visible, Jezzi and Coyne noted that the altimeter read 3500 feet with a rate of climb of 1000 fpm. Coyne stated that the collective was still in the full-down position.

Coyne gingerly raised the collective. The helicopter climbed nearly another 300 feet before positive control was regained. Then the crew felt a slight "bump."

Coyne descended to the previous cruise altitude of 2500 feet; radio contact with Akron/Canton was easily achieved, and the flight continued to Cleveland without further incident.

The day following the incident, Capt. Coyne went to P.J. Vollmer, Federal Aviation Authority Chief of Operations at Hopkins Field, to find how and where to report the occurrence. In a taped interview with Dr. Hynek, Vollmer said:

I'll never, all the rest of my life, forget that man [Coyne] coming in here [approximately 2 pm]. I have known Coyne for some time, not personally, not even socially, but I personally have an extremely high regard for his integrity and his capability. In a case of this kind, I don't know anybody that I would believe any more. I trust his judgment without a question of a doubt. I don't know what happened, but I do know--I could tell from the tremor of his voice, which wasn't much--that he was shook. He felt the feeling, inside of himself--this is what I gathered--that it had to come out of him. This knowledge and information. He needed advice on reporting it somewhere, but he didn't know where to go.

However, Vollmer could not suggest an official agency to which to report, so the matter rested until Coyne related the event to his cousin, a reporter for the Cleveland Plain Dealer (see page 113 for newspaper story). Even after the newspaper account, there was no official interest expressed in the matter, so Coyne filled out Operational Hazard reports a month later in order that the incident be officially on record (Appendix

Figure 2

Captain Coyne and the
UH-1H Helicopter



Interior of Helicopter with
Outward-facing Rear Seats

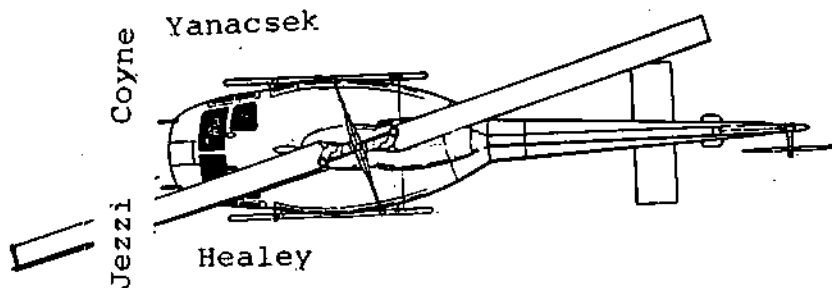
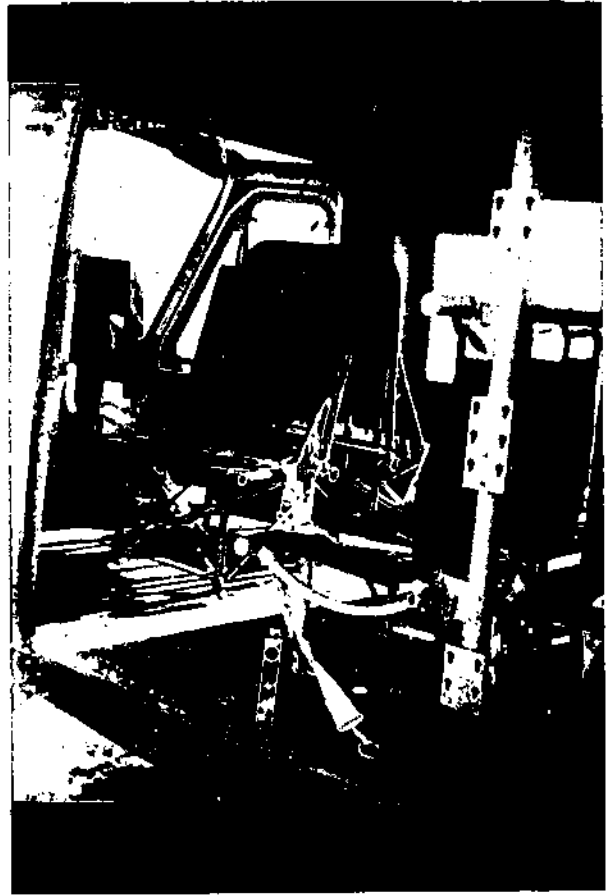


Figure 3

POSITIONS OF CREW MEMBERS WITHIN HELICOPTER

CHAPTER I

TESTIMONY

Coyne

After learning of the happening from the press, Dr. Hynek interviewed Capt. Coyne, the pilot in command, at the first opportunity, which was January 24, 1974. In the spring of 1976, at Dr. Hynek's request, I talked with Coyne, also.

Hynek Interview

Dr. Hynek's interview with Coyne took place at Cleveland Hopkins Airport in a UH-1H helicopter, an identical model to the one in which the event occurred.

Coyne: Basically, Jezzi was sitting here [see Fig.3] and I was sitting here, and John, he was sitting in this seat, and Yanacsek, the crew chief, was seated here, looking out this window. Jezzi had the controls. We were flying along, level altitude, 2500 feet. Yanacsek said, "There's a light on the horizon," and I looked out and told him to keep an eye on it. And I looked out this window here, to the right.

Hynek: Coming in from the east, then. You were going north.

Coyne: Yeah, and he said this thing was paralleling us, and I looked again and I said, "Well, check it out." And then he said that the thing was closing, and when I looked, the thing was coming at us. It was coming directly at the helicopter and it got larger and lar-

ger. And I'm looking out this window, now. I told Jezzi, "I have the controls," and I took the controls, and the first thing I did was push it down [the collective]. We started to descend. Here's your vertical speed, right here, and we went down to 500 feet per minute, okay? And we're maintaining 90 kts, so then I took the cyclic and I pushed it forward. About 20⁰ lower than the horizon. Our airspeed went to 100 kts, our altimeter, which was reading 2500, started down, 'cause it [vertical speed] was showing 2000 fpm. It kept coming right at us, and I saw it was still coming, directly for the helicopter.

Hynek: It was paralleling at first, though, you say. . . .

Coyne: It was paralleling us, right.

Hynek: Was it gaining on you, would you say?

Coyne: No, it wasn't ahead of us or behind us, it was even with us.

Hynek: But getting closer, though.

Coyne: Well, when it was paralleling, it didn't look like it was closing. Then it started coming at us, and as it came at us, I saw it was closing, and going faster and faster, and I said, "Holy Christ, that could be a jet," and [indistinct] said, "No, that's not a jet. It's moving too fast because of our altitude,"* and I looked and we were going through 2000 feet now. . . .

Hynek: Going through 2000 feet, going down. . . .

Coyne: We'd been at 2500, and it started coming at us, and I pushed the collective down. And I saw it was coming at us, and I saw we weren't descending fast enough, so I pushed the cyclic forward to get our nose down, to

*Federal Air Regulations stipulate that below 10,000 feet msl aircraft speeds must not exceed 250 kts except to preserve the safety of the aircraft.

get 2000 feet per minute, and it still kept coming at us. We were going down in altitude, and it looked like it was still coming at us--it was descending in altitude also. It was coming to wipe us out, you know? We descended from 2500, we're down 500 feet already, and then, let's see, I said the son of a gun is gonna hit us, y'know? And I braced--I figured this was it. What do you do when you have an automobile accident? You just stiffen up. And then they said look! and I looked, and there it was, right here. . . .

Hynek: At about your 1 o'clock position, and 30° up. . . .

Coyne: Right about here, okay? And they were looking from your position, either out through here, or through here. . . .

Hynek: By now it was close enough that they didn't have to look out the side windows.

Coyne: Right. Now, the light swung 90° and came into the cockpit, here. Now we fly at night and these instruments are all red lights, here. Everything turned green. Now, it could be, maybe because of this.
[Indicates green-tinted panels of overhead windows.]

Hynek: But that's not very green.

Coyne: Here, I'll just give you an idea. [Holds up white card to sunlight coming through window.]

Hynek: It looks yellow-green, but it looks mostly yellow, and also, that's sunlight. . . .

Coyne: They said look! I looked and I saw it, right here, and then it moved this way . . . it went over this way, to the west.

Hynek: Did it change its angle, or change its course, or. . . ?

Coyne: No, it stopped over us, and then it just slowly moved, while I thought we were descending, 'cause I remember

it was 1700 feet and I thought, "Oh, this is it," and then I saw it right in front here, and I said, "That's no F-100!" Then it moved this way, and I looked at my altitude and we were at 3500, climbing to 3800, past 3500, and the collective is still down. This [the cyclic] is forward.

Hynek: Now, who else saw the altimeter at that time?

Coyne: Rick [Jezzi] could see it, but I don't know whether John could or not. The first thing I looked at was this [the altimeter] and this [rate-of-climb]. And I saw we were at 3500, and I saw it was 1000 fpm.

Hynek: Vertical ascent.

Coyne: Vertical ascent. Climbing. We're still on a heading of 030. Our airspeed was 100 kts. And we're at 6600 rpm. We were maintaining our rpm, but we were in position--the controls--for descent. You know, in autorotation, a controlled autorotation.

Hynek: Hmmm. This [collective] was still down. . . .

Coyne: I had called Mansfield tower. Here's the radio. I had called Mansfield on UHF, 257.8. Now this is the UHF frequency. If this doesn't work, you go to your VHF. Then here's your transponder, here. We had the transponder on. We called on this radio, and we called on this [other] radio, and we changed frequencies twice on it. Went from 257.8 to Cleveland radio, to Mansfield radio 255.4, and I think we called Mansfield tower on--what the hell is it--119.8 or something like that, on the VHF frequency. And when you key your mike, you hear a keying tone, you know? And we heard that, so when you press the key, the switch, you hear the transmitting sound, and there was nothing. They said, "Go ahead, Army one-five triple-four."

Hynek: They heard you.

Coyne: Yeah, they said they heard us and yet they say they can't find it on the tapes. They said they had three or four different tapes going, frequencies going.

Hynek: You had radio communication to begin with?

Coyne: Yes, they acknowledged.

Hynek: When did you first call Mansfield?

Coyne: Oh, it was still approaching us. When I saw the thing coming at us, and I said, "That thing looks like a fighter!" I said, "Do you have any high-performance aircraft in this area at 2500 feet?" And there was no answer. I said, "Mansfield tower, this is Army one-five-triple-four." I said, "Do you have any high performance aircraft flying in this area at a speed of 600 kts?" Nothing. I said, "Call them, Rick," and he called them. Nothing.

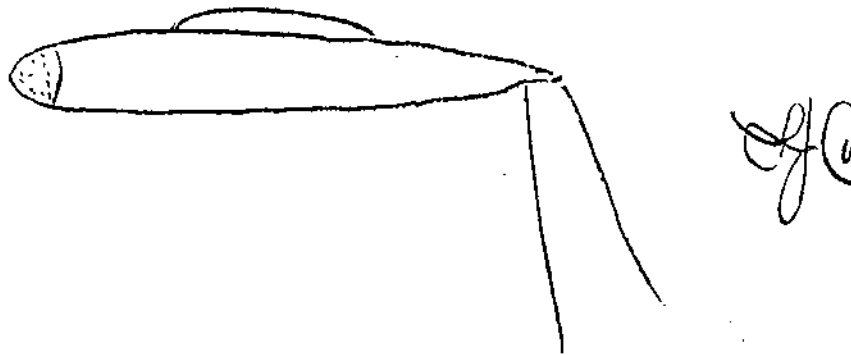
Hynek: When you say "nothing," you mean no answer? You got no answer?

Coyne: Right. Now you change frequencies, change channels, you hear a channel tone. A buzzing sound and then a stop. That means the channel change. And it did change. And then--nothing.

Hynek: By "nothing" you mean you weren't getting out or. . . .

Coyne: There was the tone. But then there was nothing. And yet the radio worked, because we were talking to Mansfield just before, without a change, and we got Ashland and Medina--we made contact--the first people we made contact with [after] was Akron Approach, and we got a position report from them, and we just carried on, and I could see this object that was moved away. I saw the red as it was coming, and I saw a red and green here [as the object was in front] and this is where I drew the picture of the object.

Figure 4
COYNE'S DRAWING OF OBJECT



The next portion of the tape concerns Dr. Hynek taking photos of Coyne pointing out the windshield (Frontispiece) and a discussion of the drawing made by Coyne (Fig. 4).

Hynek: Now Larry is showing me his drawing. The reason you put this first line here [the line around the nose] was why?

Coyne: Okay. The first line indicates where the red light stopped. To delineate where the red light stopped and the gray metallic structure began. You could also see the red reflection off the gray metallic structure. As you looked farther aft, in the center of the structure, you could see the gray, and the, in the trailing edge you could see the green light

and off the gray structure you could see the reflection of the green light.

Hynek: Where was the white light that you saw?

Coyne: I didn't see the white light until it was moving west.

Hynek: The green, then, was beaming down this way?

Coyne: Down on a 45 . . . and this light [the green] swung around from 180° to . . . or swung 90° to our position and came into the cockpit.

Hynek: I see.

Coyne: It was just all gray. There were no lights or anything other than the red and the green.

Hynek: The one thing I want to ask about the outlines: were they fuzzy or sharp?

Coyne: Distinct. Distinct. Because the stars were blotted out, you know. It was dark, but you could see the ground. And with the stars you could actually see the outline of the structure.

That evening Hynek had dinner with Coyne, Healey, and Yanacsek. It was during their relaxed evening conversation that Coyne, describing the incident to Hynek, said, "It was like looking into another world."

Zeidman Interview

Two-and-a-half years later, I reviewed the event with Coyne at Cleveland Hopkins Airport. Coyne was in the pilot's seat of a UH-1H; I was in the right rear seat immediately behind him.

Coyne: I took a look and I could see the light and see it was moving toward the helicopter. At which time I got on the radio, with my heel mike here, and I pressed that. We were tuned into Mansfield and I said, "Mansfield, this is Army helicopter 15444: do you have any high-performance aircraft in your area?"

I let go of the mike, and he came back and said, "This is Mansfield Approach, go ahead Army one-five-triple-four." I stepped on it again. "This is one-five-triple-four. Do you have any high-performance aircraft in your area?" I let go of the mike.

Nothing. [Coyne means there was no response.]

Yanacsek said, "The aircraft is closing."

I saw it. I tell Jezzi, "I have the controls," and I grabbed the controls from Jezzi. I saw it was coming and I pushed down on the collective and we began to settle. Generally we descend at 500 fpm. A general procedure. But I can't give you the time. I just went down a little. I'm watching the object and checking my instruments. I'm watching and reacting. It's moving at us, and it looks like it's going to ram us right by the door. I take the collective and I push it all the way down.

Looking now, our airspeed is 90 kts. I push the cyclic forward and increase our speed to 100 kts to help get the aircraft moving, and the helicopter begins to descend. Okay. The object is coming closer and I'm checking my instruments 'cause I see the ground is coming up and . . . 1700 feet . . . it looks like the thing is gonna impact with us. And Healey says, "Look!" And I look at the altimeter and it says 1700 feet and I look up and the thing is right there, in front of us. The object was all across the window. I could see it very clearly. It covered the entire window, not just a spot. The red light was here. And where the red

light stopped you could see the red reflecting on the structure. Very definite. The red constant glow.

And behind it the green light comes out--a pyramid-shaped light--and swings 90° and just comes this way, and comes into this window and it seems like it takes up the whole aircraft. Everything turns green. And I said, "That's no F-100!" And Yanacsek is looking over my shoulder and Healey is looking over and Jezzi is staring. Then the light . . . the aircraft . . . the vehicle . . . begins to move this way, and I asked Jezzi, "Do you have it?" and he says, "I see a white light." And Healey is looking at it through here [front] and part of it up there [above]. And then we could see it moving towards Mansfield. The faster it accelerated the brighter the white light got. It did a 45° turn when it cleared between Mansfield and the Mansfield airport, headed toward Lake Erie and the Sandusky area, and in the Sandusky area it did a 45 attitude climb, out into space. The light became very bright until it disappeared.

Zeidman: How did it disappear, and how did you know it was going away, if it was getting brighter? Going away and getting brighter is against the laws of physics.

Coyne: It just suddenly snapped out, and you could tell it was receding because of the flight path, the trajectory. There was no doubt it was going away. At that time we contacted Akron-Canton. We could not get hold of Mansfield at all. We called Akron-Canton radio, and they answered. The radios were functioning fine then, and Akron-Canton says, "You are over the . . . you are so many miles north of Ashland."

Zeidman: You got a transponder fix?

Coyne: Yeah, right. And we said, "Fine." All we said was what was our position. And I said, "Healey and Yanacsek, keep an eye out for that thing in case it

comes back to take another pass at us." In my opinion, that thing tried to ram us. To kill us. That's what my fear was. And I moved us back to Cleveland at 110 kts, almost max airspeed.

But before that point, while we could still see it, I says, "My God, we're at 3500 feet," and I says, "What's happening?" The collective was bottomed. It wouldn't go down any farther, and while I was looking at the instruments, the altimeter was going up to 3800. I pulled the collective up and then pushed it down and the helicopter seemed to settle. I never touched this [collective] until I noticed the helicopter was at 3500 feet and climbing.

Zeidman: But you didn't see it [the altimeter]?

Coyne: Yes, I did. I noticed there was a climb, but I didn't think there would be that rate of a climb.

Zeidman: Well, didn't you wonder "why are we climbing--the collective is down!"

Coyne: I figured turbulence.

Zeidman: Did you feel the climb? Did you feel any turbulence?

Coyne: No. That's what's weird. There was no turbulence, no noise. We didn't hear anything, we didn't feel anything; all we could do was see. And the fact that this thing was up to here--3500 feet--and this needle [rate of climb] was up to here--1000 fpm, and it was climbing. From the bottom position I had to pull it up, push it down, and then the helicopter seemed to bump, like it hit turbulence then. But the thing was way to the west. It was already in the Mansfield area when we began to settle. When I saw the 1000 fpm climb and read the altimeter, the collective was still in the down position. The throttle was still in the same position as when I descended. The needles were

still joined together, still running at a regular rpm.
It was a powered descent, not an autorotation.

I asked Coyne specifically about the location of the event. Coyne said that he was unable to pinpoint the exact site, although, he said:

I've flown that route a hundred times. We were just passing Mansfield. We could see Mansfield, and the Mansfield airport, and then Ashland, straight ahead. Jezzi was flying, and we were following the lights of I-71 and cross-checking with Cleveland VOR. We had the Mansfield NDB [non-directional beacon] cranked in--we always keep to the right [east] of the NDB so as to keep away from the Mansfield control area. I knew where we were, but the exact spot over the ground I can't tell you. [Locations on Fig.5]

While I was talking with Coyne on another occasion at Port Columbus, again seated in a UH-1H, we reviewed the sequence of events. He mentioned, almost as an afterthought, the helicopter compass malfunction.

Coyne: . . . and we began to settle, and the magnetic compass was. . .

Zeidman: Yes, go ahead.

Coyne: . . . was spinning.

Zeidman: This has never come out before, that the compass was spinning.

Coyne: It was completely shot. The mechanics took it out of the box and shipped it. I thought this information was in the . . .

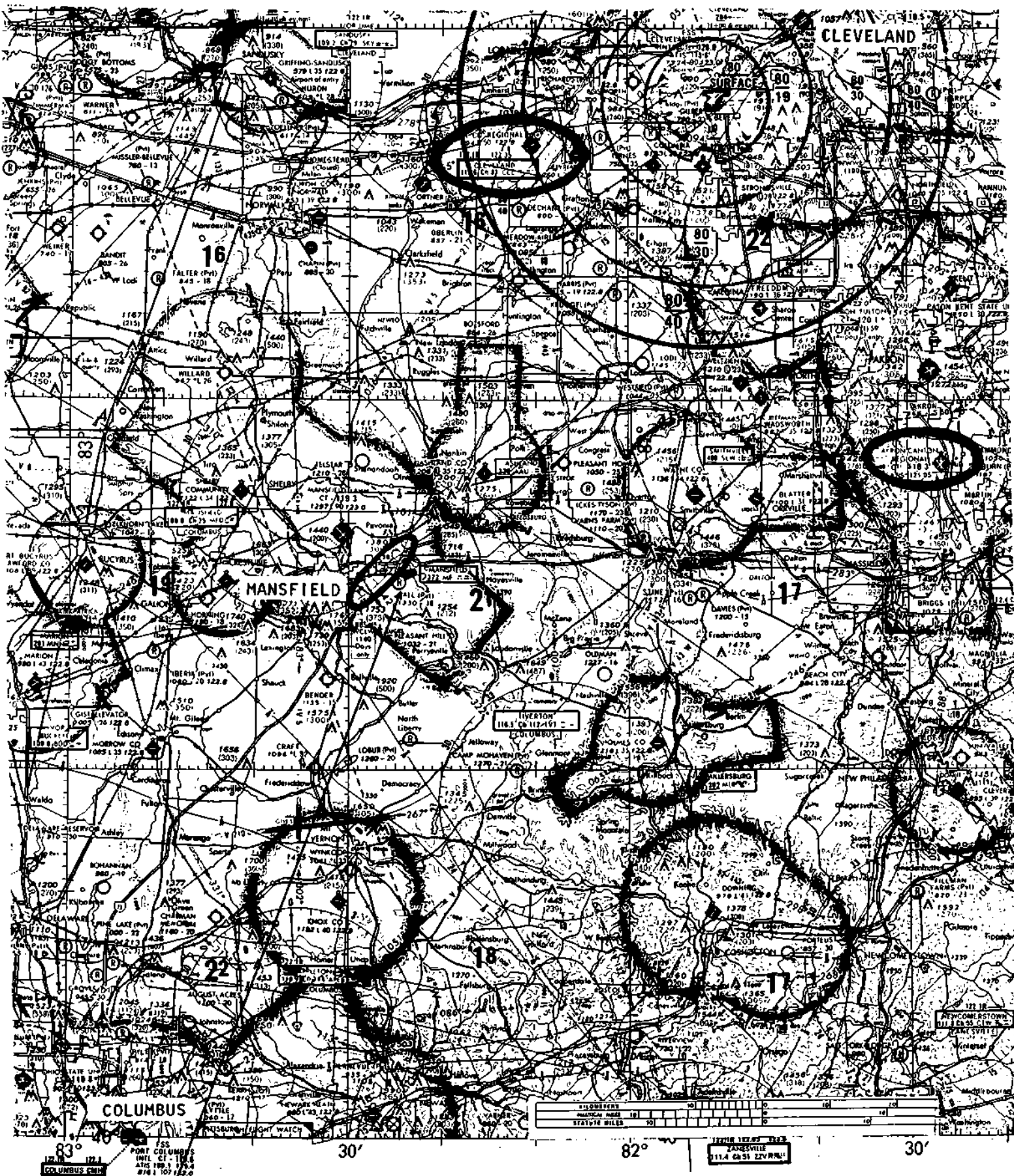
Zeidman: No. No way. This has never come out before.

Coyne: It began spinning when the vehicle, the thing, was in front of us, while it was still coming to us.

Zeidman: And you were looking at all these things [the instruments] at the same time?

Figure 5

AERONAUTICAL CHART SHOWING LOCATION OF BEACON, TOWERS AND GROUND WITNESSES



Mansfield NDB
(non-directional beacon)

Ground witnesses' location



Cleveland VOR (very-high-frequency
omni-directional range)

Akron-Canton



Coyne: Yep. This didn't spin [the RMI]. This did [the magnetic compass]. This remained constant--our radio magnetic indicator. But this just began to spin. Like crazy. It was spinning the next day after we landed. The mechanics came out. The thing was just shot. The compass was useless. We can show you the aircraft records. The compass was removed because it was completely unserviceable.

Zeidman: All right. So, how did you get reoriented, and get your heading, and so on?

Coyne: Well, we never varied. I don't think we even deviated. There was no pedal. The problem was not the heading; it was descent and airspeed.

Zeidman: On one of the tapes, Healey said the compass remained the same.

Coyne: This compass--the RMI. There was no malfunction in any of these instruments, here. We had the Cleveland VOR on; the altimeter, the RPM, the torque--all the instruments were functioning. The only thing--this [the magnetic compass] began to spin. Now this thing will spin, a compass will drift 20° when you turn on the landing light. But this thing just kept on turning, in one direction. Kept going around: 90, 180, 270, zero, 90--continuously. It didn't drift back.

Zeidman: How fast was the compass spinning?

Coyne: [Motioning] About like that, maybe four or five--say four times a minute.

Zeidman: And the compass was actually removed?

Coyne: It was replaced. The tech inspectors went over the aircraft with the Magnaflux. They checked with the

light for skin stress on the aircraft and there were no stress factors on the aircraft.* Nothing damaged. The only thing that was bad was the compass.

* In the Zyglo method of the Magnaflux Corporation, a fluorescent penetrant is sprayed on the metal to be tested and the surface is then examined under a source of ultra-violet radiation.

Healey

The verbatim transcript below represents the first recorded description of the event: a tape made October 19, 1973. Sgt. John Healey related his experience to a colleague in the Cleveland Police Department less than 18 hours after it happened. He presented a calm and straightforward account interspersed with moments of restrained desperation and hysterical, almost sobbing laughter.

. . . The light seemed to be getting brighter and brighter. And it appeared that it was on a collision course. And we were at about 3000 feet, and the pilot took the controls from the co-pilot and he put the helicopter into a power dive and we lost 500 feet immediately if not sooner. And this object cleared our aircraft by about 500 feet. It had a steady red light on the nose; it was cigar-shaped and had a green light shining down from the aft end. It was like a gun-metal gray and it made no noise nor were there any vibrations or air turbulences. It went from the eastern horizon to our point in a matter of about two minutes, and then from there it continued in a direction of about 270° till it got near the horizon. Then it broke off and did about a . . . to 340° and was lost on the horizon, just like that.

When it was all over we were all pretty scared because at the speed this thing was moving . . . now it's a funny thing, it came from the horizon very quickly but when it went over our aircraft, its speed was very slow until it passed over our aircraft and then it picked up speed again. This is the odd thing about it. Because the helicopter has green . . . we call it the greenhouse. It's a green roof, green windows, over the

top of the pilot and co-pilot so they can see directly up; it's tinted against the sun. I was standing right in the aisle between the pilot and co-pilot and we were looking right there through the greenhouse watching this thing, and it damn near came to a stop right over us. And then it started up again. So we all got a very good look at it. There were no windows that I could see.

It just hesitated for a moment--dropped its airspeed very low--and then just picked right up again and took off. And there's nothing we've got that's that slow and fast in the air, that can slow down and start up again that fast. There were no engines, and no air turbulence. This thing didn't have any wings. I don't know how the hell he got around, but he did. And if we hadn't dived, we probably would have been involved in a collision, because this thing only cleared us by about 500 feet. If we had stayed on 3000 feet it probably would have hit us. The speed that this thing moved from the horizon was fantastic; it really put on the k's.

When we first observed this little red light it looked like a navigation light, way out in the distance, but as it got closer this light got very big and very bright. It was almost like the landing lights of a 727, that's how bright this light was. Like, our navigation lights are very small bulbs on the sides of our aircraft, but this had a great big spotlight on the front of it, and that's why you could just tell from the size of it . . . this light kept getting bigger and bigger and bigger, so we didn't know what it was until it was right over us, and we could see its outline. All we could see coming at us was this one big red light. It had no blinking lights at all, or the anti-collision beacon, just the red light in the front, the green light underneath and the white light in the back. It looked like the real bright landing lights we had just seen at

Port Columbus. It was a steady light. And it scared the living hell right out of me.

Well, everybody looks at me and they laugh as I talk to people about it. They say "ha ha ha," and I laugh about it too now [laughs hysterically for four to five seconds, then stops soberly]. Well, all four of us were on board this aircraft last night. None of us ever expected to see something like this, and we've never encountered anyone who had seen anything like it, so it was a brand new experience altogether. I'll tell you the truth: any time I've ever heard anything about UFOs, I've just glanced at it; I never really got absorbed with it because I never believed in it, but now I think I'd start reading the articles, because maybe somebody'll describe what I saw.

And we had just taken our flight physicals that evening so we were all cold sober and in perfect health--we'd all passed our physicals--so it wasn't a case of we'd been out drinking or something. You just don't go near an aircraft when you've been drinking. And we left the hospital at 10:00, and we pulled pitch at 10:30, and it took us 15 minutes to get to the airfield and we filed our flight plan, and it took about 15 minutes to warm up the aircraft, and at 10:30 we were leaving, so there was no time to stop at a bar and even get halfway wasted, 'cause we can account for every minute of our time.

Healey's testimony remains consistent. Talking with his cousin, Laura Gallagher, a year later he said:

We were almost struck by an aircraft. This thing tracked us for a long time, out on the eastern horizon, and then it started on an intercepting path, so it was probably trying to dope us out, you know. Then I figure he just came in for a closer look. He was curious like we were curious, but he had the ability to outrun us.

. . . But after he took off, I watched that light for a couple of minutes, just watched it take off in a westerly direction. Then when it got near the horizon, it did a right turn of about 45° and just followed the contour of the earth, and over the horizon it went. I sat and watched it. I had nothing else to do. And it made a 45° turn and went over the edge of the world.

In December 1976, talking with CUFOs consultant Dr. Tom Evans, Professor of Psychology at John Carroll University in Cleveland, Healey said:

It had no windows, and it was a cigar-shaped affair. It looked as though it was a solid object. It definitely had substance. If I had to guess what material it was, I'd say metal. Some of the light reflected on the object. From my point, between the seats, it appeared to take up the entire--both--front windows. Surprisingly, I looked at it as a disinterested party. I had no fear that we would be involved [in a collision]. It was just something interesting to watch. I was hoping it would turn around so I could get a better look.

Evans asked Healey what left him with the greatest emotional impression. Healey replied:

The shaft of green light coming out of the underside of the aircraft. You could actually see a cone of light, a definitive cone, a light that stuck out at right angles. A spotlight has a condensed cone from the source--the filament--to the target; it doesn't grow that big. But this opened up in a triangular shape. It opened up. It wasn't just a straight beam of light coming down. It was going straight down from the aircraft, but it wasn't a condensed beam. I saw the green beam as the [object] was in front of me, out the front windshield. I didn't see it as it was going away [to the west]. Then I saw the tail light--a white light. I saw the red light

coming toward us, and when the aircraft was perpendicular to us through the windshield. What happened was I had crouched down between the two seats and that way I could look right through the windshield. I couldn't see the bright spot, the filament of the light; I could just see the cone.

I really don't remember the inside of the aircraft [the helicopter] turning green. I don't remember the green cockpit or the descent or the climb. I know Larry said the light swiveled, but I don't remember that.

Dr. Evans then talked about the perceptual phenomenon of "closure," in which the human mind is capable of taking three or more distinct points and "filling in" or "closing" them into a shape or pattern that is identifiable with respect to past experience.

Healey replied that indeed he had tried to "form the cigar shape into a recognizable aircraft, something that I could identify, an F-100 or something," but that he was unable to do so. He concluded:

We had enough time where we could watch this thing come at us, [but] when you see this thing, it staggers you because you don't know what the hell you're looking at. It was just a solid metal thing, with no rivets or seams or anything like that. I'll never forget that damn thing.

Yanacsek

Spec. 5 Robert Yanacsek had had a previous UFO experience in Viet Nam. While crew-chief of a Chinook helicopter, he watched three white lights flying in tight formation, passing beneath his helicopter as it was flying 3000 feet above the ground at night. The lights maintained their precise relationship throughout the 20 to 30-second observation, and did not appear to be attached to anything.

During the Mansfield incident, Yanacsek was seated directly behind Coyne, and had an unobstructed continuous view of the object from the time he first noticed it on the eastern horizon, through the encounter point when the object was maintaining a fixed relationship to the helicopter.

Describing his experience, Yanacsek said:

It was a clear night, a beautiful clear night, and a steady red light appeared on my right--a steady red light, not flashing--and naturally I thought it was an aircraft. It was so far away that I looked at it for some time before I mentioned it; it wasn't that important, it was so far away, and we were coming up on Mansfield, and we'd be having [radio] contact with the ground so I didn't want to bother Larry. We were too high, in my estimation, for it to be a radio tower, but it was either that or an aircraft. I figured it was an aircraft, since it wasn't flashing.

I must have watched it for a minute, oh, a minute and a half, before I said anything. A long time. [Great emphasis in Yanacsek's voice.] There was no question in my mind that it was man-made, whether it was a tower or a plane. It wasn't a star or anything.

It was a red light, and it was kind of hard to miss it.

As the object was closing, and I hate to call it a crash dive, but that's basically what it was--a last ditch effort [of the helicopter] to get out of the way in the last 20 seconds or so when it was driving straight toward us. It was obvious that it was coming at us. There was no question there. We were positive it was going to intercept us, especially since the object or whatever it was had turned in our direction to begin with. It didn't try to stay apart; it was turning toward us at the same altitude and was obviously going to come at us and intercept us. It was red the total time. There was no flashing; it was just bright red, a bright red. I saw a white light only when it was directly overhead, or--correction, correction--I think as it approached me there was a white light. Yes, I think there was because it lit up the tail a little bit and gave definite proof, if you want to say, that it was something solid, something solid and metallic. It lit up the area around the light. It was because it was coming at us at an oblique angle that it [the white light] couldn't be seen immediately.

It easily filled up the entire windshield. If I had been sitting in the front seat I probably wouldn't have been able to see anything but the aircraft, or whatever it was.

The object may have hovered over us for 10 to 12 seconds. It seemed like a long time, it seemed like it was there for so damn long. It was just stopped, for maybe 10 to 12 seconds, and I mean stopped. It wasn't cruising, it was stopped. It didn't waver, it didn't put on the brakes, it didn't gyrate--it was just like in a cartoon. It was coming at us, and then, in the next "frame," it was there, just like that. No noise, no flaps. It reminded me very much of a submarine. Silent and gliding, and just there. I really didn't think we would

really collide, because the object was obviously completely in control of the situation. . . .

The edges were sharp, because it was an exceedingly clear night out, and the solid part of it blotted out the stars right behind it, and if it had been a dark, cloudy night I probably couldn't have told too well, but it blotted out the stars in an oval shape.

Yanacsek mentioned also that there was the suggestion of a line of separate, possibly round "windows" between the main oval shape and the slight "dome section" of the object. The light from the "windows" was insignificant compared to that of the other three brighter lights on the object.

The green was in the cockpit, but I think it came from the "greenhouse." It was green inside the cockpit. The green light also came in through the windshield, which is not tinted. What happened there . . . it wasn't just a one-shot light, it seemed to swivel. Now again, whether we flew through it, or it swiveled, at any rate the light traveled across our nose into the cockpit and then up into the green area, and it washed out the entire cockpit. It might have been a maneuverable spotlight, or it might be we were passing under it; it did shine in the front. It came up over the nose into the cockpit windshield, and then it came up into the "greenhouse." It was wide and intense, like an aircraft light.

After it got out John Healey's side . . . I think we had litters and equipment and stuff, and I couldn't really see it over the co-pilot's head until it got out Healey's window. At that time it was almost as small as when it started. Very small. And white. It was way over near Mansfield. The time it took to get over there was between 30 seconds and a minute.

Jezzi

Lt. Jezzi was not available for an interview until February 12, 1977 when Dr. Hynek and I met with him. We asked Jezzi to simply "begin talking," and he quite readily launched into his description of the event.

Jezzi: That was my first flight with the Unit. I hadn't flown for three months before that. We were through with our physicals and we took off without refueling. The weather was beautiful, and our visibility was unlimited. I was flying at the time, and we were cruising at 2000 or 2500 feet, I don't remember exactly, and we were flying east of Mansfield, and there had been some conversation previously about UFO's because at the time there were a lot of stories coming out . . . the Governor of Ohio had seen them. We were flying about ten miles east of Mansfield . . . there's that F-100 Air Guard squadron stationed there, so you always look out for the jets. I think we had called the [Mansfield] tower and cleared ourselves through the zone.

At that time there was a mention of a red light on the horizon, the eastern horizon, to our right, and the conversation was that it looked like a radio tower, but it wasn't flashing, and then a few seconds later [Yanacsek] said, "No, it's not a radio tower, it appears to be moving." The next comment I heard was "it's coming toward us" and very shortly thereafter . . . I was sitting on the left side of the cockpit . . . I couldn't see what was going on, it's very hard to look toward the right, so Captain Coyne took the controls from me, put the collective down, reduced pitch, and we descended, and we dropped, oh maybe 1000 feet to about 1500 msl. We were trying to contact Mansfield

but we couldn't get them. And then all hell broke loose in the cockpit. Everybody was starting yelling and screaming about what the hell it was and that it almost hit us. That kind of conversation kept up for several minutes.* Now I never saw the object until it was almost vertically on top of us. I never saw a body to it at all. I would say it was about 100 feet above us and maybe 500 feet to our front. Fairly close. The only thing I recall seeing was a white light, a very bright, intense white light on the aft portion of the object, on the back side moving away from us. I followed that light all the way to the horizon.

Zeidman: Did it fade out, or did it snap out, or what?

Jezzi: I just saw it go away and disappear. I assume it went over the curvature. What bothers me is that it was a very intense white light, comparable to some of the approach or landing lights on a smaller aircraft. Not at all like an aft position light, which is an extremely small one, not very bright. It was much too bright, extremely bright, to be an aft position light.

Zeidman: All the time you saw the light, did it vary in color or intensity?

Jezzi: No, it stayed very bright. . . .

Zeidman: Even as it receded?

Jezzi: Yes. As I said, it was different than an aft position light. It was like a little ball of white light.

Hynek: How big, would you say? What kind of object held at arm's length. . . .

Jezzi: A nickel.

Hynek: Was it bigger than a point source?

* During the April 2, 1978 meeting, Yanacsek indignantly stated that there was not a lot of yelling and screaming. He resented Jezzi's remarks. "We were under emotional control," he said.

Jezzi: Oh, yes.

Hynek: If the full moon had been visible at the time, would it have been bigger or smaller?

Jezzi: Smaller.

Zeidman: How would you compare it to an aspirin held at arm's length?

Jezzi: About as big as two aspirins at arm's length.

Hynek: Well, the full moon would just be covered by one aspirin.

Jezzi: Oh, I've seen moons bigger than that!

There were a few moments of digression while Dr. Hynek explained the apparent angular-diameter relationship between sun, moon, and an aspirin tablet.

Zeidman: Well, were the edges fuzzy or distinct? Did it leave a beam?

Hynek: A train? Did it at any time leave a trail, a luminous trail?

Jezzi: No. As I say, it was a very intense white light. It did not leave a beam of light, like a spotlight, you get a beam. It didn't give that effect at all. It was just a single, isolated light, extremely bright.

Zeidman: What was its trajectory? A straight flight path, or. . . .

Jezzi: Linear. Its course was linear. Now, it was mentioned that there was a greenish light that colored the aircraft, that turned the Huey green for a moment as it went by. I didn't see that or sense it, and I think that since the cockpit has a greenhouse--a green plexiglas roof--that was the effect we [sic] saw. There was conversation while it was happening that it was stopping over the helicopter, that it hovered, but I didn't see that. I hadn't caught sight of it yet.

Hynek: How long was it in view? How long did it. . . ?

Jezzi: Minutes. The whole episode was over in minutes.

Hynek: The length of time you saw it. . . .

Jezzi: It's hard to say. From when I first caught sight of it and followed it to the horizon, it's hard to say whether it was a minute or 30 seconds. The whole episode took place in minutes. Maybe two? Maybe more. For my part, I saw it, I'd say, for from 30 seconds to a minute.

Zeidman: Well, you've never established how fast it was going.

Jezzi: I don't know the approach speed because I didn't see it, but as it receded it was going faster than the 250 knot limit for aircraft under 10,000--faster than 250 knots but not as fast as 600 knots, the speed that the others reported as the approach speed. I will say that it was moving faster than normal traffic at that low altitude. Closer to the 250 than the 600. In a way, I'm kind of the odd-ball in this situation because I couldn't see over to the right, and I really didn't see the first part, what the others saw.

Zeidman: Were you aware of the dive, and the climb?

Jezzi: I was aware of the dive. Your stomach went. Because Coyne really grabbed it from me. You could tell he was concerned. He was much more aware of the proximity of the object than I was. I hadn't seen it. I wasn't aware of the climb at all--and 1000 fpm--it could have been less. It was not that much of a climb, that steep, that much acceleration. But the climbing is something that occurs somewhat easily in a helicopter if you're not paying attention. If you're flying the aircraft and thinking of something else. We were talking rapidly about what was happening. You get excited and you just go like this [demonstrates by raising left arm] and you're climbing. And going from 1500 to 3000 feet in two or three minutes is not going

to be that extraordinary. There are thermals that are so bad that you put your collective down and you're still climbing. I've had it happen to me.

Zeidman: Do you think Larry was responsible for the climb?

Jezzi: I don't know. Larry said, "Son of a gun, it pulled us up!"

Zeidman: You weren't following through [on the controls]. . . .

Jezzi: No, I didn't have the controls. I don't know what he did. I saw the altitude. I recall it was over 3000, it could have been 3500 feet, and we were still talking, still trying to get Mansfield on the radio. I'm pretty sure it [the object] had disappeared by then because it faded out, and I immediately looked back over [at the instruments] and that's when I caught the altitude. The object must have been gone by then because while I could still see it, I was looking at it.

Hynek: Now sort of lean back and take a deep breath and try to recall--take as much time as you want--and recall the conversation just after it happened.

Jezzi: After it disappeared? Well, I recall Coyne's comment about the different light colorations. And the word "cigar-like shape" came out at that time. And they talked that it appeared to hover over us. Of course, there was a lot of "what the hell was it?" and "we almost got killed," and then they talked about the climb. Was the climb the result of the vacuum the other aircraft left? I don't know. It's hard to really explain. I really did not see what the others did see. The thing that really grabs me, it was so spontaneous. The remarks in the cockpit, the dialogue was so spontaneous. There was something there, and it was different. That these people, who had been flying a long time, couldn't identify it. The light didn't

vary in color or intensity all the time I saw it, even as it went away from us. It was very bright. It was different from an air navigation light. As I said, it was just like a little ball. . . .

Zeidman: Going back to the radio malfunction, to what do you attribute the radio malfunction? Was that an unusual event?

Jezzi: In that unit, no. It happened from time to time. Because our maintenance, our avionics, were not that good. Things like--you'd have poor transmission and then all of a sudden it came in, or it was garbled. So I don't know if it was part of the incident or not. We had VHF. Some of the birds didn't have the two radios, and I recall it was always hard to transmit and receive on UHF because everybody prefers VHF civilian-wise, but we tried to receive on the VOR and transmit on UHF, et cetera, Fox Mike, the whole thing, and we couldn't get contact until very close to Cleveland.

Zeidman: Do you know anything about the magnetic compass malfunctioning?

Jezzi: Oh, yes. Triple-four's magnetic compass was never the same afterwards. Whether it was like that before I don't know.

Zeidman: Larry says the compass was changed, replaced.

Jezzi: Yeah, they did that, I recall. I know they did that after the incident. That mag compass never worked.

Zeidman: He said the RMI was fine.

Jezzi: Yeah. But that's true about the mag compass. But I think the new one was goofy, too. It was funny because I did fly that aircraft months later, and it would do a 360 without any reason at all. . . .

Zeidman: Wait a minute. You flew Triple-four months later and the new compass didn't work?

Jezzi: The new compass was still bad. You could check the records. . . .

Zeidman: I've asked Larry for the records. He says he can't find them.

Jezzi: Huh. Strange. The records are supposed to stay. . . .

Zeidman: Right, stay with the aircraft for the life of the aircraft.* While all this was going on, was there any particular time when you were especially worried about what was going on?

Jezzi: No. Well, I was worried about this approaching object or whatever it was, because I couldn't see it.

Zeidman: They thought you were going to have a collision. . . .

Jezzi: I didn't experience that because I never saw how close it was until after it had crossed over. So I have no idea how close we came.

Hynek: Do you think it has a natural explanation?

Jezzi: Well, I was trying to figure out if it was an aircraft or a jet with a navigational light problem, and if it were flying, let's say, from SE to NW, which is really what happened--and the angle--and if he's flying that way, and we're going to see the left wing light first, red, okay?

Zeidman: But if he were having a problem, and all your lights were working, he wouldn't come straight at you, he'd try to avoid you.

Jezzi: Sure, and there's no reason to think he didn't see us. According to what the others said, he was acting like he deliberately--er, that he did see us. But the thing is the aft light. And the discrepancy I see here is that it was very, very bright for an aft light.

* Jezzi and I were both wrong. I have since been informed by the head of avionics at the helicopter maintenance facility that records of minor instrument changes are only kept for 60 days.

And we didn't see a strobe or a rotating beacon, either. Which is an FAA regulation. You've got to have it to fly at night. But the lighting [configuration] shoots my whole theory down. If it was a high-performance aircraft, it must have had a nut for a pilot. The lights were all wrong, and only 500 feet above the hills? At night? I'd hate to do that with a Lear at that speed.

Zeidman: Was there any noise or any turbulence?

Jezzi: No, none. But you said about being worried. We flew back to Cleveland and almost ran out of gas. Had nine gallons of fuel left in our Huey.* We had flown 12 minutes into the 20-minute fuel warning light. That's what really scared me the most, the fuel problem. I had my shoulder harness locked, and I was praying. I knew it was going to be close. We got clearance from Cleveland, and we came right on in.

I came back to the airport on Saturday to fly for an extra training period, and at that time Coyne was talking to a reporter from a Cleveland paper. He had a picture of the cigar-shaped object with the slight cockpit and the thick light on the bottom and a kind of red nose. Bob Yanacsek came in later that day with the same picture, and it was interesting--the coincidence that two people drew the same thing. Yanacsek had just come in so I don't think, I don't know, if they had compared them before.

* When asked later about this point, Coyne said that he had been unaware of the "nine gallon" figure, although he realized he was using more fuel than usual, high-tailing it back to Cleveland. Jezzi did not give his source for the fuel measurement.

The Ground Witnesses

Recognizing the potential value of locating ground witnesses to the event, the Civil Commission on Aerial Phenomena (CCAP), a small group of technically-oriented central Ohio people interested in UFOs, had published in the Mansfield News Journal of August 19, 1976, a story reviewing the Coyne case and calling for witnesses to come forth (see Appendix). That same evening, Warren Nicholson, CCAP director, received a long-distance call from Charles C.,* a youth who claimed that he, his mother and siblings had witnessed the event. Within a few days, Nicholson and his associate William E. Jones conducted an extensive interview with the family.

On a second extensive interview, Nicholson was accompanied by CCAP investigators John Lenihan (a police helicopter pilot) and Tim Wegner. My follow-up interview consisted of a nearly two-hour session with the family at the site. Nicholson remains the principal investigator of the ground witnesses, and the preponderance of the following quoted material is excerpted from his tapes. To preserve continuity and clarify the sequence of events, I have integrated verbatim quotes from both my tapes and the Nicholson transcripts into a chronological narrative.

*His mother requested that the family's name not be published.

At approximately 10:40 pm on October 18, 1973, Mrs. C. left the Mansfield home of her mother-in-law to return to her own home in rural Ashland County. (Locations relevant to the ground-witness testimony may be found on map, Fig. 6). Accompanying her were her three children: Charles, then aged 13; Camille, 11; and Curt, 10. Also in the car was Karen B., 13, a step-sister of Mrs. C.'s husband. They were all aware of the current flurry of UFO activity in the central Ohio area and the subject had been mentioned earlier in the evening.

As they drove south on Laver Road at a speed of approximately 35 mph, a bright red light caught the attention of Mrs. C., Camille, Charlie, and Karen. Curt's view was obstructed (see Fig. 8 for seating arrangement). The light was at two-o'clock high* when first seen. It seemed, Mrs. C. said, to be at medium altitude, and was flying south, paralleling Laver Road. The family's attention was attracted to it only because it was a single steady light, decidedly brighter than a star or a plane. The speed of the light was "about that of a jet," and as it proceeded ahead of them it remained just the one steady red light--no other colors, no strobe, no rotating beacon. The red light pursued its southerly course and had already disappeared

* The clock positions refer to the standard reference method of visualizing the observer's position as in the center of a clock face, with 12 o'clock being precisely to the front, 6 o'clock behind, etc.

from view over the trees at the intersection where Laver Road ends at Route 430 by the time the car had reached that point.

The family's next increment of travel was eastward, from the intersection of Laver Road and Route 430, to the Route 430 bridge over the Charles Mill Reservoir, a distance of 3.6 miles, which they covered in approximately five minutes, steadily descending toward the lake at an average speed of about 45 mph.

The last 500 feet of the approach to the bridge is desolate, flat, and swampy. The road berm is trimmed back about ten feet and then brush and tall trees take over, a tangled, uninviting terrain. A line of utility poles follows the south side of the road.

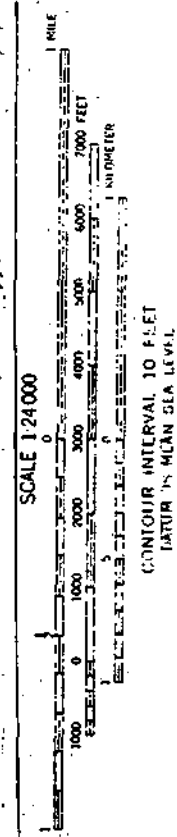
As they entered that portion of the road they saw ahead in their one o'clock position (almost due east) a red and a green light, moving together, coming down rapidly toward them. They first thought it was a light plane, flying low over the lake, but changed their minds almost immediately; the red was too bright, especially compared to the green.

"It looked like a big red light. It wasn't flashing," Mrs. C. told Nicholson. "The red light appeared to be more toward the front. The lights stayed on; they never flashed."

Mrs. C. began to slow the car.

There was general agreement among the children that the red light was the brighter of the two and that it appeared to be the leading, forward light. They could see no shape to the

PATHS OF OBJECT AND HELICOPTER AS DESCRIBED BY GROUND WITNESSES



- | | | |
|--------------------|---|----------------------------|
| Route of C. family | A | Family first saw red light |
| Path of object | B | Family first saw object |
| Path of helicopter | C | Car was parked |
| | D | Bridge |

object, and no noise was discernible at that time.

As the car slowed down, the lights appeared to move more slowly and farther to the right, to the car's two-to-three o'clock position. "It looked like at one time that it stood still," Mrs. C. reported.

The space between the lights increased as their distance from the car appeared to decrease. Camille reported that just before the lights moved out of her view to the right, she could make out a shape. Her drawing (Fig. 10) shows a domed shape with a yellow light, the only yellow light mentioned by any of the witnesses. There was strong agreement that at this point the object seemed almost stationary.

Now with the car halted at the roadside, but with the motor and lights still on, Mrs. C., Camille, and Charlie became aware of a second group of lights, some of them flashing, approaching from behind them (the southwest). At this point they became aware of noise for the first time. Mrs. C. thought the two sets of lights were helicopters about to crash.

Charles: There was a whole bunch of noise.

Jones: What kind of noise was it?

Charles: A bunch of racket. It was sort of rattling, like tin or a knocking sound [Charles raps on table].

Jones: Where did the noise come from?

Charles: Up in the sky. It was like beating the air.*

*An excellent description of the very distinctive sound of a Huey helicopter.

Mrs. C., Charles, and Camille, twisting around in the car, could see through the side windows that the steady-lighted object and the object with flashing lights were converging. The witnesses believe it was at about this point that they first realized that a helicopter was involved.

Mrs. C.: The one object went over the top of the other one. And then it stopped.

Nicholson: Did any of the lights appear to be a streak? By a streak I mean if you take a sparkler and move it very fast through the air and you see a sort of streak through the air, or did it appear to be more of a pinpoint type of light?

Mrs. C. There was no streaking to them at all.

Nicholson: Are you sure? Did it move so fast that a streak . . . ?

Mrs. C. No. Neither one did.

Jones: What color was this object?

Mrs. C.: What do you mean?

Jones: What color did you see from it?

Mrs. C.: Just the red and the green.

Jones: Do you mean from the helicopter?

Mrs. C.: No, from the object above the helicopter.

Jones: Were the red and the green the same size?

Mrs. C.: No, the green light seemed smaller. It was not of the same brightness.

Jones: The green was smaller?

Mrs. C.: Yes. There are different versions. I know the kids have seen something . . . they say they see something a little different than I do, but I'm just telling you what I saw. We parked down here by the bridge. The helicopter seemed

to be coming basically from the south or southwest and the object was also basically south of me.

After probably less than 30 seconds of watching the objects, and over the mother's protestations, Karen and Charlie piled out of the car and stood by the right rear fender. Karen did not want to leave the car, but was forced to by Charles in his zeal to get out of the two-door vehicle. The illustration (Fig. 7) by Allan Hendry* is based upon the witnesses' description and a photo of the site taken by Nicholson.

Charles: [Standing outside of the car, at the site, pointing towards the southwest] When we got out of the car it was right there, sitting there.

Zeidman: How long did it remain stationary?

Charles: Two minutes. No. Not even that long. And it was longways, like this [indicates that horizontal axis of object was toward observers].

Zeidman: Hold something at arms' length. How big would it be? Would a dime cover it? [Hands Karen a dime.]

Karen: [Holds dime at arms' length.] Oh, bigger.

Zeidman: Well, there's the sun. While it's behind the cloud, take a quick squint at it. Was the thing bigger than the sun?

Charles: Bigger than that. It was a big ol' thing.

Karen: Yeah.

* Chief Investigator for Center for UFO Studies and managing editor of the International UFO Reporter.

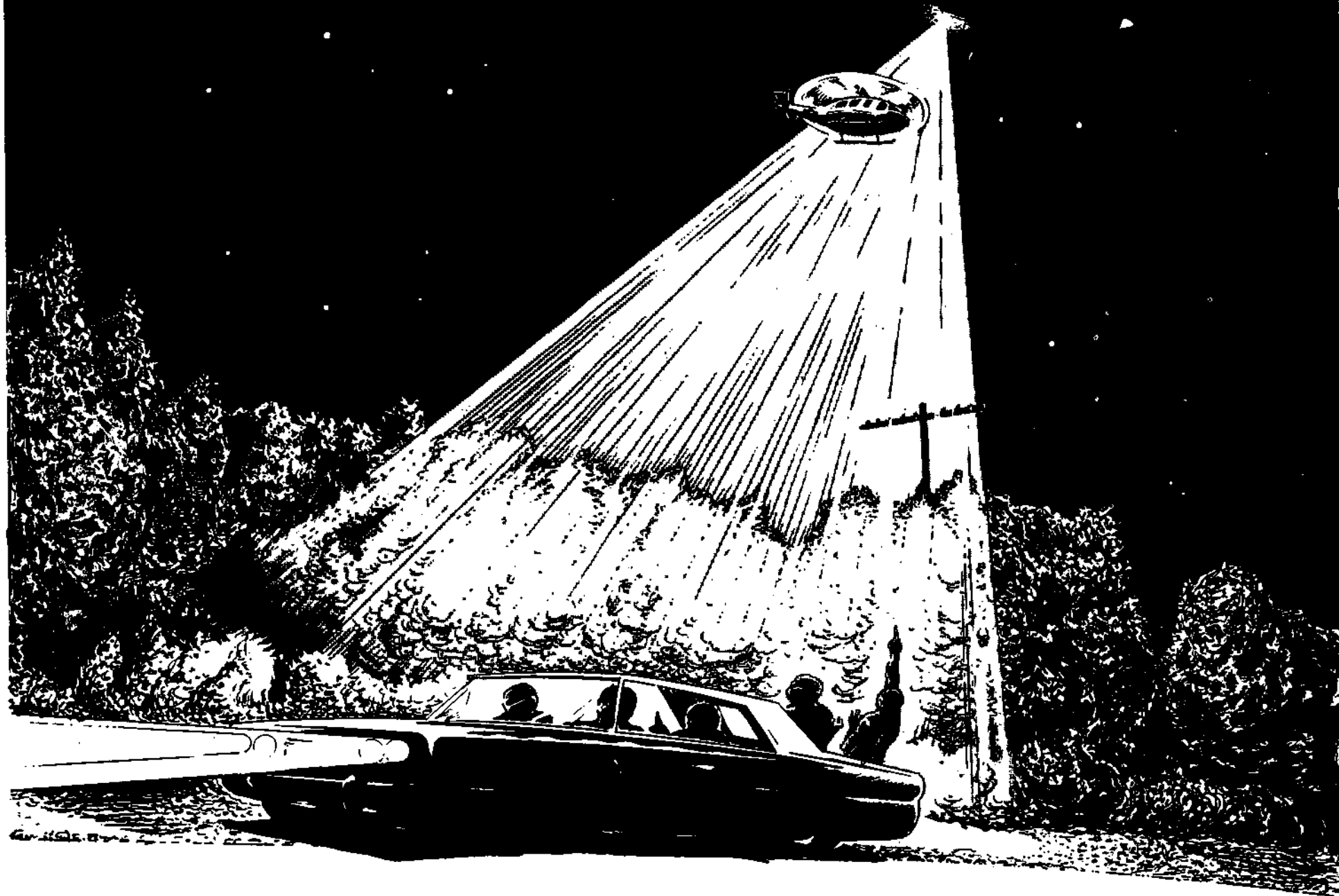


Figure 7. THE GROUND WITNESSES' OBSERVATION

Drawing by Allan Hendry

Zeidman: Describe it to me.

Charles: It was something like a blimp. Shaped like a blimp.

Zeidman: What color was it? Tell me if it was painted-- like the whole thing was painted, or was the whole thing glowing? Were the edges fuzzy or sharp?

Charles: You couldn't see them. I mean you could see them, but it was dark, and you couldn't tell how it was built.

Charles had described the shape to Nicholson as "long and kind of round. It would be kind of pear-shaped with the big part of the pear facing toward you. The light seemed to be coming from the bottom." Karen had mentioned that the light "seemed to come from the side or the back," and that at one point after the object and helicopter converged they appeared to move together westward "for a little ways [estimated less than 100 feet]" parallel to the road. She was the only one who reported this motion.

Throughout the three interviews, Charles and Karen repeatedly mentioned a flare-up of the green light.

Charles: When we got out, everything was green. I saw that thing and the helicopter.

Karen: Everything turned green.

Charles: It lit up everything green. It couldn't have been no higher than . . . it was a great big thing. I don't know exactly how high it was . . . it was a great big thing. There was a whole bunch of noise. We were driving out 430, going home, and all of a sudden we heard this noise and I looked up and out the back window. . . .

Nicholson: Was the light a flash or was it long-lasting?
Charles: We saw the green light for 10 seconds. Not very high. Maybe 500 feet. It was a light, dull green. I know it sounds crazy, but it was a light, dull green. Everything just turned green. I think the green came from above the helicopter. It kind of looked like rays coming down.

Karen: We wanted to go home and lock the doors. We were scared.

Nicholson: [In the second interview] When it lit up green, did it light up the whole countryside or just the immediate area?
Charles: It was so bright that you couldn't see too far. It just seemed that right around us . . . it was . . . everything was green. The trees, the car, everything.

Nicholson: Do you remember what color the helicopter was?
Charles: Green.
Nicholson: Why was it green?
Charles: Because of the light from the thing up above! I think I could see windows in the helicopter.

Wegner: Did the thing above the helicopter remind you of anything you have ever seen before on TV, or in a movie, or anything like that?
Charles: Uh huh [negative]--except maybe a school bus.

Wegner: Was the helicopter bigger or smaller or the same size as the object?
Charles: The helicopter was smaller.

Nicholson: Do you remember seeing anyone fishing [in the nearby lake]?
Charles: No, I don't remember seeing anyone fishing. You couldn't see too far, anyhow. Everything

was just so green from it, you could only see a short way 'cause it was just so bright.

Nicholson: Where was the helicopter in relation to the thing?

Charles: Just barely ahead and below--the helicopter was ahead and below. And then the helicopter seemed to pass over us and we looked around and couldn't see the thing then. It was gone. It was just gone. When the light went out you couldn't see the object.

Wegner: You couldn't see it any more? Did it fly off?

Charles: I don't know. It was just gone. And then we saw this helicopter fly across the road.

Wegner: What direction was the helicopter going?

Charles: Northeast. The helicopter went northeast. Then we got back in the car and went on. The thing could have been right overhead. I don't know. We got back into the car and then we saw it [the helicopter] fly out over the lake.

Zeidman: [In the third interview] Were you already back in the car when it crossed the road . . . did you actually see it cross the road?

Karen: When we got back in the car it started.

Zeidman: How far back of you did it cross the road?

Curt: Just beyond those trees [estimated 100-150 feet].

Zeidman: Did it cast any reflection on the road?

Karen: Uh huh [affirmative].

Camille: A green light.

Charles: Everything was green.

Curt: We looked back and it was crossing the road. It kept coming at us and getting bigger and then it crossed the road. Then the car started moving and it seemed like it followed us.

Charles: We looked back and it was gone!

Curt: Uh huh [negative]. It didn't! When we started going we looked around and we could see it over there [out left side of car]. It was going just like that [indicating it appeared to be pacing the car].

Charles: Following the car--it was just gone.

Curt: [Negative sound] We turned around and saw it, heading out that way, towards Mansfield. We were going faster, all right. It just flew off and got smaller and smaller toward the northwest.

Mrs. C.: We were scared.

Curt: When it went back toward Mansfield it went behind the trees; that's the way it disappeared. I saw it go back. I didn't see it turn around. It just stopped and went back.

Zeidman: It reversed itself?

Curt: It just went backward.

Camille: [In the third interview] That light was so bright, when Charlie was standing outside. But nobody else could see it.

Zeidman: What do you mean, Camille?

Camille: When we were looking up there, and Charlie was standing outside, that light seemed to be so bright, but nobody else around here could see it. [No one else reported it. J.Z.]

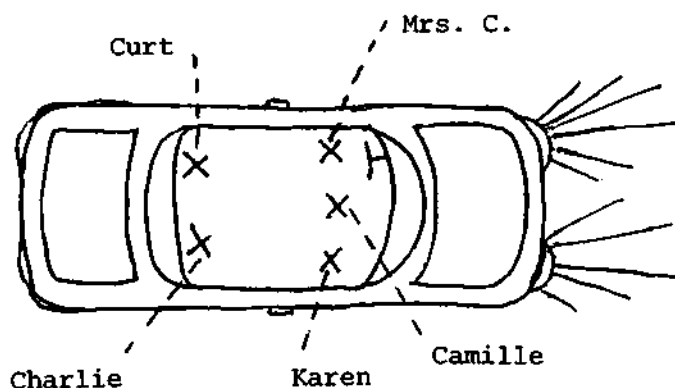
Charles: You should have been able to see that light from anywhere.

Curt: Miles!

Camille: It was high up when we first saw it, and then it came down lower. When it was beside us it was about the same as the trees.

Charles and Karen said they were out of the car for about a minute and that the green flare-up lasted about ten seconds. Mrs. C. estimated the total time the car was actually stopped as "not over a couple of minutes." She remembers the green light, but not an intense flare. Her comment that the red light was brighter than the green refers to the appearance of the object as it approached from the east. When the two objects were at a relatively high angular elevation behind the car, her view was obstructed. She was becoming quite apprehensive by that time, was worried about the two children outside the car, and she thought she was looking forward, eastward across the bridge, in the hope (vain) that other road traffic would appear. Although both helicopter and object were seen separately after they diverged, the actual break-off of the two objects was reported by no one. The testimony, however, suggests that the divergence occurred close in time to when the two objects crossed the road. When last seen by Curt and Charlie, the group of lights which they identified as the helicopter were proceeding alone northeast over the lake--at a higher altitude than when previously seen south of the road. Curt's attention and angle of view were directed primarily toward the departing object; Charlie, in the mid-section of the car, could see best toward the northeast.

Figure 8 Positions of Ground Witnesses Within Car



Commentary on the Ground Witnesses' Testimony

Throughout the three interviews with the ground witnesses, there was a constant lively exchange among them. The observers were not trying to please the investigators or each other, especially concerning the motions of helicopter and object during the period when the two objects were crossing the road. This is not surprising since the witnesses' attentions were variously focused upon re-entering the car (Charles and Karen), looking out the right window (Camille), the rear window (Curt), and the front windshield (Mrs. C.).

The ground witness tapes have been repeatedly reviewed and there exists not the slightest hint of collusion between the mother and the four children. At no time in the three interviews did the mother "coach" the children into a response; she listened to their reports and presented her own, regardless of variation. No one in the family used the terms "UFO" or "flying saucer" in describing the event; usually they referred to "the object" or "the thing."

At no time throughout the more than five hours of the three interviews was there any indication that the thought of remuneration or publicity had ever entered their minds. The family was in domestic upheaval and Mrs. C. was adamant that she did not want to "make waves." Had it not been for the newspaper story and Charles' assertiveness in phoning Nicholson (a toll call), they never would have reported the incident at all; indeed, before the newspaper story mentioning Nicholson, they had no idea where to report it.

The use of "leading questions" in the three interviews could have provided ample opportunity for the witnesses to agree with the previously suggested responses: that the object moved fast enough to cause a "streak"; that the object was "cigar-shaped," as illustrated and described in the newspaper article; that the object was glowing; or that it reminded the witnesses or something in a movie or on TV. However, all of these "suggestions" were rejected.

Nicholson and Jones met with Mrs. C.'s mother-in-law at the time of the first interview. She corroborated that the witnesses had told her of the incident within a few days of its occurrence. I met with her also, and to me she said, "They've been telling the same story all along. Everything lit up--that's what she [Karen] told me."

FIGURE 9. COMPARISON OF OBSERVER TESTIMONY

Observer/ Interviewer	Observer Looking Through	Object Shape/ Appearance	Approach Color	Departure Color	Departure Duration	Movement of Object at Closest Point	Movement of Green Light	Shape of Green Light
Coyne to Hynek and to Zeidman	Front wind- shield	Cigar; distinct sharp edges	Red	White	Still in view when 3500' alt. noticed	Stopped momen- tarily	Swung 90° into cockpit	Pyramid
Healey to Zeidman/ Evans	Both front and upper windows	Oval/ cigar, solid	Red	White	A couple of minutes	Nearly stopped	No movement seen	Triangular cone
Jezzi to Zeidman/ Hynek	Upper window	Ball of intense light	View ob- structed	White	30 secs. to a min.	Very slow	No green seen	Not seen
Yanacsek to Zeidman	Upper window and Front window	Light Solid, submarine	Red	White	Between 30 secs. and a minute	Stopped for 10-12 seconds	Swung into a/c	Wide and Intense
Ground wit- nesses to Nicholson and Zeidman	Car windows, open air	Pear, blimp, solid	Red	Not stated	View obscured by trees	Station- ary for at least 30 seconds	Not stated	Like rays coming down

Points of Similarity and Dissimilarity

It is apparent from the previous testimony that there is substantial agreement among air and ground witnesses concerning the major aspects of the event. Figure 9 compares the various facets of observer testimony.

Points of Similarity

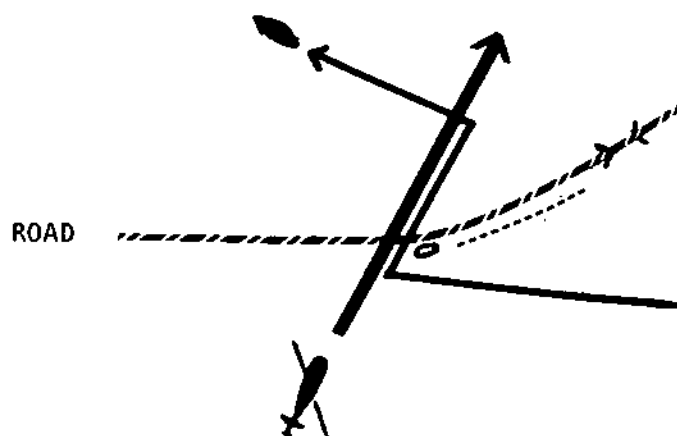
1. The date was October 18, 1973, the time a few minutes past 11:00 pm.
2. The location was east of Mansfield, Ohio, east of I-71, and east of the Mansfield NDB (see Figure 5).
3. The helicopter approached from the SW.
4. The object approached from ESE.
5. The steady red light was on the front of the object.
6. There was a short-lived bright green flare or beam of unusual nature.
7. Except for a few seconds of green flare-up, the red light was the predominant one.
8. The object was not entirely symmetrical.
9. The object assumed a position over the helicopter.
10. The helicopter did not deviate; its last direction was NE.
11. The object's last reported direction of travel was NW.
12. The flight path of the object as described by the ground witnesses corresponds to its flight path based upon the crew testimony.

The portion of the object's flight path described by the ground observers as "crossing the road" and "following the car eastward" at first appears to be a discrepancy with respect to

the crew testimony. However, it is easily shown to be a point of corroboration,* and it is listed as point 12 above. To the crew within the moving helicopter, the motion of the object was perceived as 1) approach from the east, 2) deceleration/hovering, and 3) resumption of westward course. The crew did not distinguish the actual forward motion of the object; it was perceived by them as the hovering phase of the event. Figure 6 and Figure 10 below show these components of the object's flight path; they are also easily demonstrated by taking one's two hands and describing the linear motion of the helicopter (left hand) and the "zigzag" motion of the object (right hand).

Curt's report that the object "seemed like it followed us" [paced the car eastward for a short distance] can now be shown to be a product of his interpretation of the object's flight path NE relative to the ENE path of the car.

Figure 10. Object's Zigzag Flight Path



*I am indebted to Philip J. Klass for bringing this to my attention.

A separate point of coincidence, apart from the actual UFO/helicopter encounter at the Route 430 bridge, is the steady red light observed as the C. family was driving south on Laver Road. That incident preceded the Route 430 encounter by 5+ minutes. Healey had observed a single red light flying south, off to his left, "three to four" minutes before Yanacsek's first mention of the red light on the SE horizon.

Dissimilarities

Jezzi's account is somewhat different from those of the other eight witnesses. Because his view was obstructed by Coyne's body, Jezzi came in "in the middle" of the event, at the point when the object was just passing the helicopter's meridian. From that point on, all four crewmen reported only a bright white light heading off to the northwest. At the time that the others were exclaiming that the object was stopping, it had not yet entered Jezzi's view.

Considering only the last portion of the event, the difference between Jezzi's account and the others' involves the object's course (Jezzi described it as linear, Coyne and Healey reported a 45° turn near the western horizon), and the point in time of the disappearance. (Jezzi said it disappeared just before he looked at the altimeter and became aware of the climb, whereas Coyne stated that the object was still easily in view after he noted the 3500' altimeter reading.)

Another discrepancy involves the ground witnesses who testified that both helicopter and object, after their convergence, appeared to remain stationary for a discernible period

of time, perhaps even several seconds, before they started to cross Route 430. The aircrew was unaware of this. Their attentions were solidly focused upon the unknown object/light as it appeared in front/above them, and they assumed their machine was progressing forward at a speed of approximately 100 kts. I would not discount the possibility that "the objects remained stationary" increment was a misperception by the ground witnesses of the flight paths of helicopter and object at the point where the helicopter was in transition from dive to climb, and it and the object were moving essentially on line of sight toward the observers.

Karen B., on the ground, described both aircraft and object moving westward "a little ways," later estimated as less than 100 feet. She was the only one to report that motion.

CHAPTER II

THE UNKNOWN OBJECT

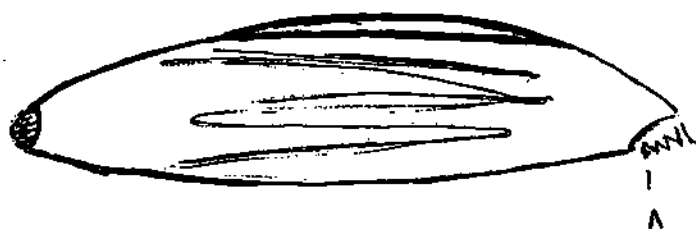
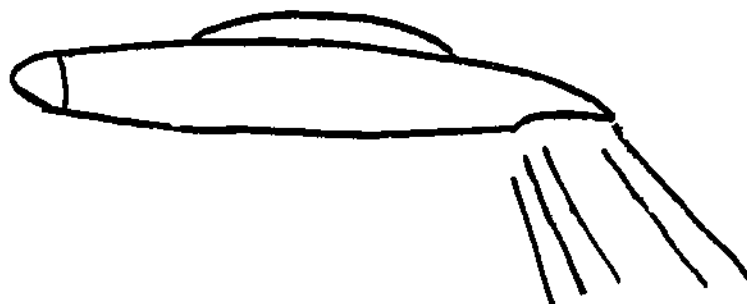
The characteristics of the unknown object which preclude its identification in terms of known phenomena are its appearance, its motion, the length of time it was visible, and the peculiar nature of a green light on its aft portion. The crew's first assumption was that it was a plane, though other commentators have advanced the hypothesis of a meteor to explain the event.

Appearance

The unknown object appeared only as a red light during the first portion of the event. At the closest approach to the helicopter, its appearance was that of a solid, cigar or oval-shaped, gray, metallic structure, slightly domed, with sharply defined edges. The silhouette of the object blotted out the background stars. Charlie C., on the ground, described it as "like a blimp," "kind of pear-shaped," "a big, ol' thing." Coyne, Healey, and Yanacsek all reported three precisely positioned lights: red emanating from the nose, a green "beam" with maneuverable spotlight capabilities emanating from the under/aft portion of the structure, and a bright white light which came from the "tail" of the object. The ground witnesses reported the red nose and green beam lights. Jezzi, who did not witness the object's approach, concurred with his crewmates that during the departure phase, only the bright white light was visible.

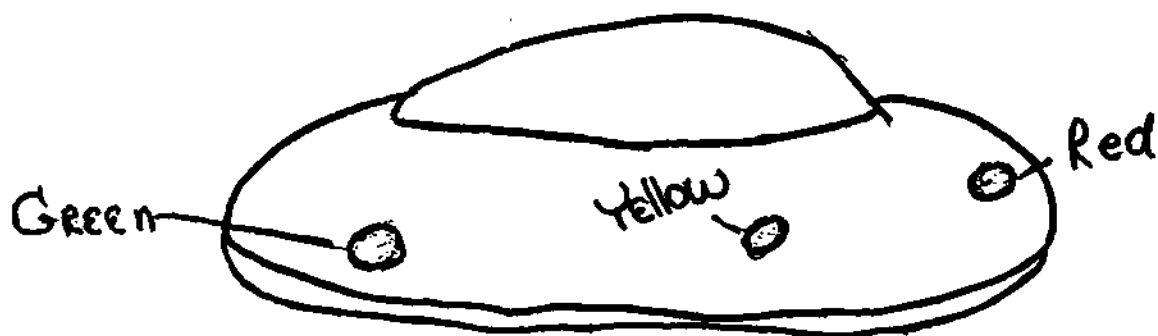
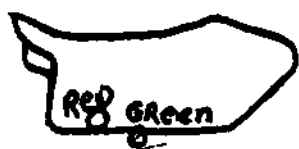
Figure 11. WITNESSES' DRAWINGS OF OBJECT

Coyne



Yanacsek

Curt



Camille

The Distance/Size of the Object

With an unfamiliar object of unknown dimensions, it is impossible to arrive at any accurate estimate of size or distance, unless a familiar object of known dimension can be seen in direct relationship to the unknown.

What is curious in this case is the agreement in the estimate of each crew member on the size and distance of the object. Both Coyne and Healey stated it was about 60 feet in length (about the size of their helicopter), 100 feet above and 500 feet away. Jezzi described it as a light 100 feet above and 500 feet in front of the helicopter.

According to Coyne, the object at its closest point (in front of, and slightly above the helicopter) "filled an entire front windshield panel" (see Figure 12). For Healey, crouching between the seats, it seemed to fill both windshield panels. Yanacsek said that it easily filled one windshield panel, and he thought that had he been sitting in the front seat, it would have filled both windows.

Determination of the distance and size of the object was attempted by graphical methods using the distance from the observers' eyes to points on the precisely measurable windshield panel. Measurements from Yanacsek's position (twisting and cringing to his left) and from Healey's (crouching behind the front seats) were considered, but found too variable for this purpose. Coyne's position in the front seat was more reliably measured, and those figures produced an angle of view (for Coyne) of approximately 75 degrees.

The relationships between length of an object and distance from an observer for objects that subtend an angle of 75 degrees are as follows:

	20'	13'	Distance
Overall	60	39	from
length	100	65	observer
of	300	195	to
object	767	500	object

Thus it is suggested that the "500 feet away and 60 feet long" estimates provided by Coyne, Healey, and Jezzi are not compatible with the more objective figures obtained through trigonometric computation and the direct visual report of the ground witnesses. The ground witnesses reported that the object and the helicopter were close together, one essentially over the other, and although they reported that the UFO was "larger than the helicopter," none of them reported that it was "much larger," as would be indicated on the table for a 500-foot distance. An approximate distance of 65 feet and a linear size of approximately 100 feet best fits the distance and proportions described by the ground witnesses.

Figure 12

COYNE'S DRAWING OF OBJECT SUPERIMPOSED ON PHOTO OF WINDSHIELD

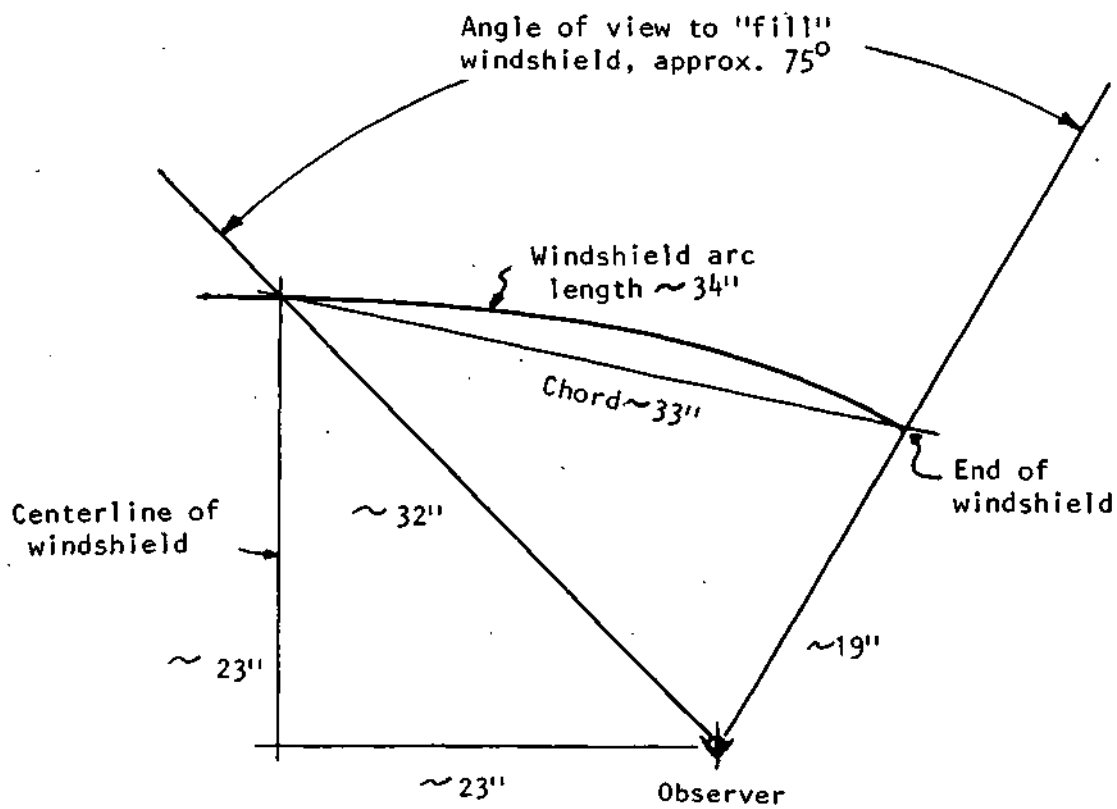
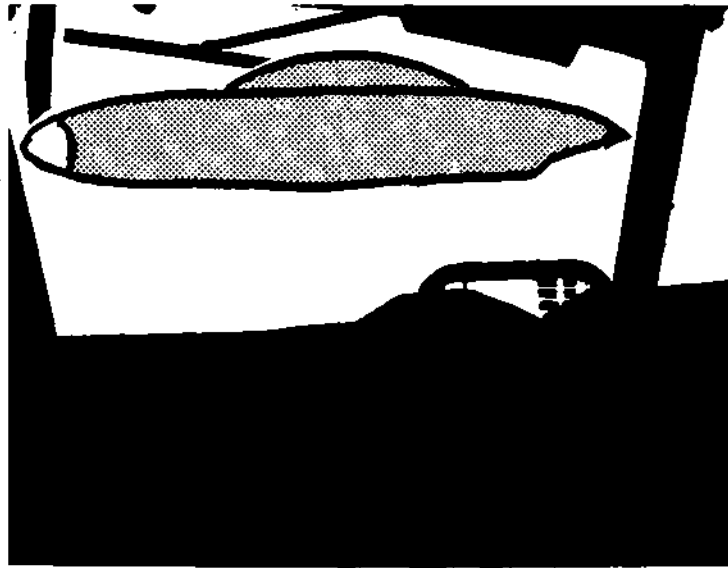
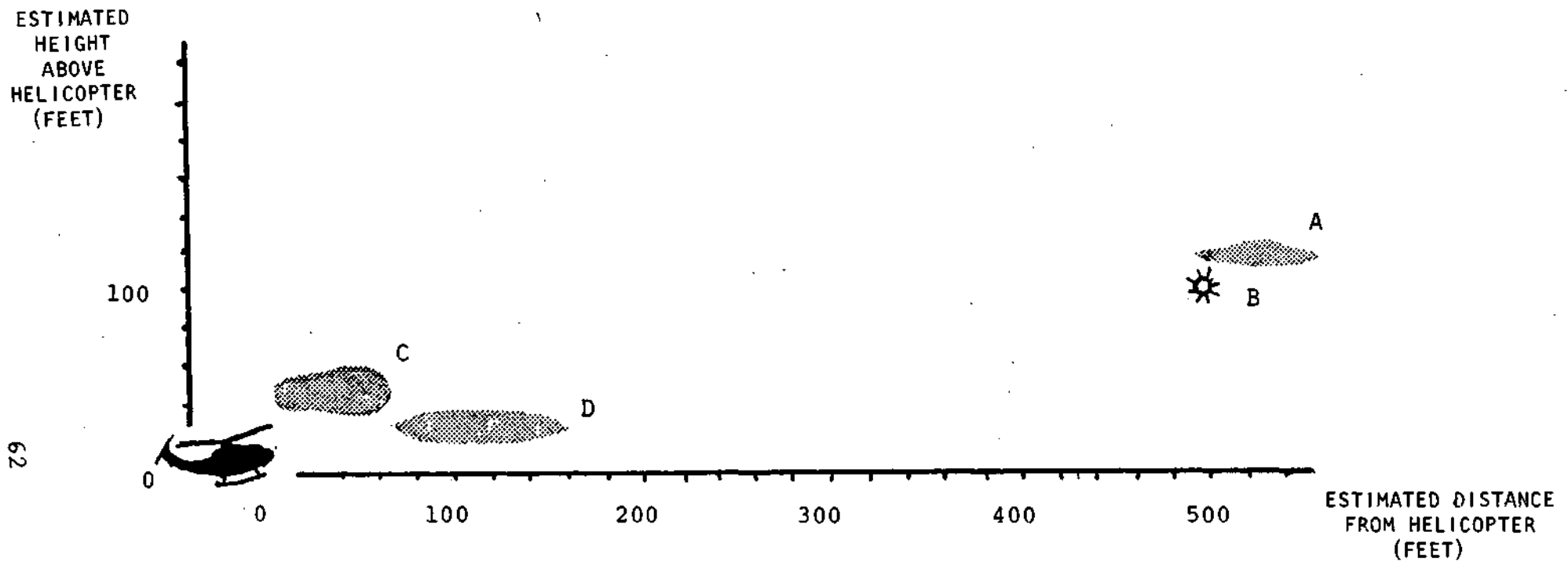


Figure 13

GEOMETRICAL RELATIONSHIP OF LENGTH THAT "FILLED WINDSHIELD" TO DISTANCE

Figure 14.

FOUR PERSPECTIVES OF OBJECT-HELICOPTER RELATIONSHIP



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- A Coyne and Healey described object as 100' above and 500' in front of helicopter and 60' in length.
- B Jezzi described intense white ball of light as 100' above and 500' in front.
- C Ground witnesses saw helicopter and object in relationship to one another.
- D Apparent object size measured against window frame suggests length of 100' and distance of 65.'

Motion

The reported motion of the object can best be shown by listing the various increments of its flight path:

Figure 15

Motion	Observer(s)	Est. Speed
Light appeared stationary on horizon (did not change relationship with helicopter)	Yanacsek Coyne	
Light appeared to turn toward helicopter	Yanacsek	
Light appeared to be rapidly approaching	Yanacsek Coyne Healey Ground witnesses	600 kts
Object appeared to decelerate or actually stop as it passed closest to helicopter (course and speed decreased to match that of helicopter)	Yanacsek Coyne Healey Ground witnesses	0 kts
Object moved from S to N side of road at an oblique angle to approach path	Ground witnesses	slow
Object flew off to NW	Crew Jezzi	> 250 kts
Object made 45° turn before disappearance	Coyne Healey	

Thus, both aircrew and ground witness testimony indicate that during continuous observation the object exhibited flight trajectories which included precise hard-angle turns and an apparent range of speed from zero to 600 kts. Both characteristics disqualify it for identification in terms of a natural phenomenon.

Duration of the Observation

How long was the object under observation? Figure 15 presents the various increments of the encounter based upon analysis of witness testimony, and Figure 16 translates those increments into movement through space.

Consistently, Coyne has stated that the object was still visible after he noticed the climb, and even until the helicopter was again descending to cruising altitude. At variance is Jezzi's recollection that the object disappeared immediately before he noticed the altimeter. Jezzi had the better view to the west and he did not have the controls to contend with; however, more than three years had elapsed after the event before he was queried as to the specific details of the incident. The two men in the rear of the helicopter cannot contribute to this point: their attentions were fixed upon the departing object; they were not concerned with the technicalities of the helicopter's flight or instruments, and they were unaware of the climb until Coyne brought it to their attention.

Thus it is the discrepancy between Coyne and Jezzi which provides the 60-second spread to the final segments of the event, and is responsible for the "15-second leveling off and regaining control" and the "10-second departure" increments in the Median column of Figure 15.

The climb duration of 108 seconds is based upon the 1700-foot-to-3500 feet altimeter readings and the 1000 fpm vertical ascent reading. It does not include the undetermined extra

time necessary for acceleration into the climb from the level flight attitude.

Although in Figures 16 and 17 the climb duration is presented as an assumption, it actually reflects only a supposition. If the climb were a "normal" one (using the only "hard" figures we have--an 1800-foot climb at 1000 fpm), it must have taken 108+ seconds. Of course, if the climb were not normal--i.e., if the object had somehow affected the helicopter's flight--then theoretically the climb could have consumed any length of time.

Returning to the various crew testimonies, if Jezzi is correct, then the object disappeared after an elapsed time of approximately 275 seconds. If Coyne is correct, it could have remained in view for 330 seconds or even longer. The "compromise" figure of "300 seconds $\pm$ 30" takes into consideration Jezzi's statements that the object was traveling faster than 250 kts and slower than 600 kts, that he thought it was "closer to 250 than 600," and that he followed it all the way to the horizon. If we choose 350 kts as the object's departure speed, and 15 miles as the horizon distance, then a time of 134 seconds for the departure would be indicated. Healey, also on the left side of the helicopter, reported "a couple of minutes" as the departure time. Yanacsek said "30 seconds to a minute." The men sitting on the left side of the helicopter should probably be given higher observer ratings than Coyne who was busy with the controls, or Yanacsek whose view was interrupted by Jezzi's body and pieces of equipment.

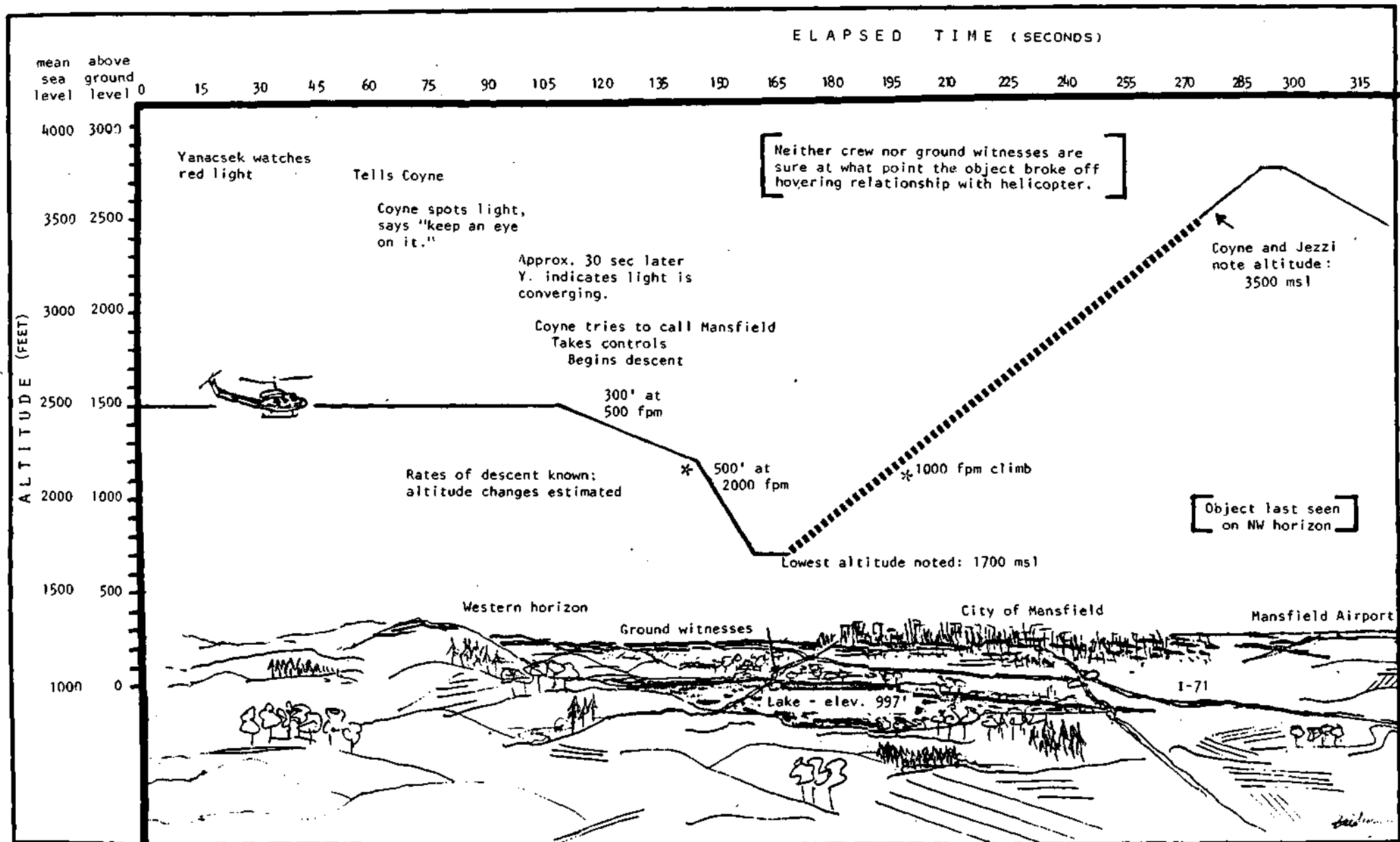
Figure 16. ELAPSED TIME ANALYSIS

Description	Est. Time (seconds)		
	Short	Long	Median
<u>Object Approach</u>			
"It was so far away that I looked at it for some time before I mentioned it. I must have watched it for a minute, oh, a minute and a half, before I said anything" (Yanacsek).	30	90	60
"Yanacsek said, 'There's a red light on the horizon at about 3 o'clock--are there any radio towers over that way?' I told him to keep an eye on it" (Coyne).	10	15	13
"After approximately another 30 seconds, Yanacsek indicated that the light was converging on the helicopter" (Coyne on Report Form 2496).	15	30	30
Coyne looks over, evaluates, decides to take evasive action (Coyne).	5	5	5
<u>Aircraft Descent</u>			
2500' - 1700' = 800' in two increments: 1st = 500 fpm; 2nd = 2000 fpm as consistently reported by Coyne. Altitude change in each segment unknown.	24 (a) 18	48 (b) 12	36 (c) 15
<u>Closest Point</u>			
"It damn near came to a stop right over us" (Healey).			
"It wasn't cruising, it was stopped for maybe 10-12 seconds, and I mean stopped" (Yanacsek).	3	10	8
"It stopped over us, and then it just slowly moved" (Coyne).			
"The object came over the helicopter, and then it just stopped, for about 10 seconds" (ground witnesses).			
<u>Aircraft Ascent</u>			
From 1700' to 3500' = 1800' @ 1000 fpm (Coyne).	108	108	108
<u>Leveling, Regaining Control</u>			
3500' to "near 3800'" "From the bottom position, I had to pull it up [the collective], push it down, and then the helicopter seemed to bump like it hit turbulence" (Coyne).		20	15
<u>Object Departure</u>			
"But the thing was way to the west. It was already in the Mansfield area when we began to settle. The first people we made contact with was Akron Approach, and I could see this object that was moved away" (Coyne).		60	10
"I watched it depart for a couple of minutes" (Healey).			
	213	398	300

(a) 200' @ 500 fpm = 24 (b) 400' @ 500 fpm = 48 (c) 300' @ 500 fpm = 36
 600' @ 2000 fpm = 18 400' @ 2000 fpm = 12 500' @ 2000 fpm = 15

FIGURE 17

LENGTH OF OBSERVATION FROM WITNESSES' ACCOUNTS



* The descent and climb estimates do not take into account the additional times needed for acceleration or deceleration.

The Beam of Green Light

The joint testimony indicates that just as the object reached the helicopter's "meridian," a green light on the aft underportion of the object became visible to Yanacsek, Coyne, and Healey. It was visible to the ground witnesses as the object approached. The green light became a beam while the object was in front of the helicopter. The beam appeared to travel upward across the helicopter nose and windshield, and when it reached the upper, tinted windows, the maximum affect was achieved and "everything turned green." Before that point, there was no glare effect and the object shape was easily defined.

The most impressive aspect of the entire experience, Coyne said (as had Healey), was the peculiar quality of the green light which emanated from or near the indentation at the aft end of the otherwise symmetrical shape of the unknown craft.

Coyne: The aft engine light [sic] did not leave a trail, just a white, bright reflection that dissolved into the night. When the light of the green light penetrated into the night, it cut right through the night, the darkness, and it was definitely shaped like a pyramid. The further in length it went, the wider it got, whereas the white light dissolved into the darkness. You could see the white as the thing passed over us, but it became more apparent as it was moving away. The object moved very slow away from us, and then it began to accelerate. As it began to accelerate, that white light became even brighter. Very bright.

Zeidman: But still the same color?

Coyne: Oh, yes. Stayed white. Just brighter in intensity. And then when it turned, it became brighter and went

over the horizon and just [snaps finger] went out. But the green light was definitely different. It cut through the night. Now the night lights [the helicopter instrument lights] which are red--everything turned green in here. The light didn't come through here, where it's green [indicating overhead window panels]. It came through here [front windshield]. This green [upper panels] wouldn't make the red disappear.

Healey had also emphasized "a definitive cone, a light that stuck out at right angles . . . [which] opened up in a triangular shape . . . it wasn't a condensed beam." (See page 24.)

The young ground witnesses also had repeatedly mentioned the green light as the outstanding feature of their experience. Directly comparable to the statements of Coyne and Healey is Charlie's description, "It was like rays coming down."

Preliminary Explanatory Hypotheses

There are two obvious prosaic possible explanations for the reported phenomenon: the object was a meteor or the object was an aircraft. The following two sections consider these two possibilities in detail.

Possibility of High-Performance Aircraft

As the Huey flew northward from Columbus into the Mansfield area, Yanacsek and Healey, sitting in the rear seats facing outward, were charged with the normal procedure of observing and reporting any relevant traffic. The four men were well aware that they would be flying through a zone of possible low-altitude jet aircraft from the Mansfield Air National Guard base; they were also aware of the current flurry of UFO activity in the area, but were on a routine flight which three of them had made many times before. Were they exceptionally alert or taking any particular precautions? I think not. Healey told me, in a tone of some apology, that he had been drowsy. Coyne described himself as "relaxing, smoking."

When Yanacsek first reported a red light, like an obstruction light on the SE horizon, Coyne merely told him to "check it out," and the initial report created no interest. When Yanacsek subsequently reported that the light appeared to be moving toward them, Coyne became concerned, began actively observing the light, and called the Mansfield Tower with his request for local traffic conditions.

As the light approached, all of the crew assumed it to be a high-performance aircraft--probably an F-100 from Mansfield.

As they dived evasively and the object decelerated, Coyne remembers yelling, "That's no F-100!"

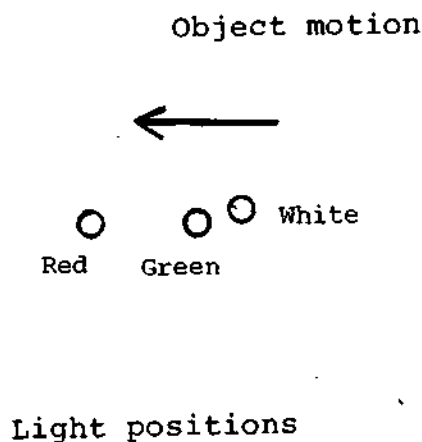
Could the object have been a high-performance aircraft? Aspects of that possibility are presented in the following two-column summary.

Figure 18

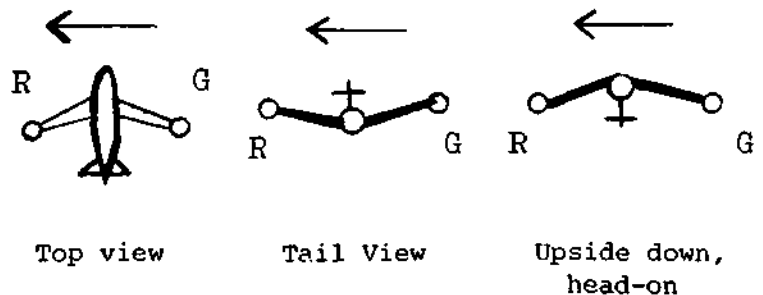
The Possibility of High-Performance Aircraft

<u>Reported</u>	<u>However</u>
1. Object approached at speed estimated at 600 kts, decelerated rapidly, hovered over helicopter as it moved forward, then passed off to the NW.	a. A fixed-wing aircraft would not have the capacity of decelerating from high velocity to hover or near-hover in only a few seconds. b. A helicopter would have the capacity of hovering, but would not be capable of the high forward speeds reported.
2. Object was at its slowest speed as it passed directly in front of and closest to the helicopter.	a. A fixed-wing aircraft moving across the line of sight at generally constant velocity would appear to move more rapidly when passing directly in front of an observer.
3. No noise or turbulence was noticed during the close approach of the object.	a. A conventional aircraft, if within 500 ft, would have produced noise heard inside the helicopter. b. The night was calm and the flight totally smooth. Any turbulence would have been noted as an anomaly.
4. Object was described by Coyne, Healey, Yanacsek, and ground witnesses as a smooth, cigar-shape, with slight dome on top, and lights. Jezzi reported no object, only a light.	a. At such close quarters, some of the features of a conventional aircraft should have been identifiable--wings, engine pods, windows, empennage, numbers.

5. Color configuration showed the red light leading.



- a. No conventionally-lighted aircraft carries a bright red light on its nose.
- b. In order for any fixed-wing aircraft to present the reported color configuration, the aircraft would have to have been flying:



6. Unknown object had bright white light on aft portion.

- a. Conventional aircraft may have white tail lights, but not of the exceptional brilliance or intensity described by crew members.
- b. Neither piston nor jet aircraft present bright white engine exhaust.

7. All lights on the object were constant.

- a. FAA requires either a strobe or a rotating beacon on top or bottom of fuselage.

8. The object was reported at speeds as high as 600 kts at an altitude as low as 1800 ft msl.

- a. FAR Part 91 requires that below 10,000 ft msl no aircraft shall fly faster than 250 kts.

In addition, when Captain Coyne checked with the FAA, he could find no record of any other aircraft in the area, and the last known F-100 of the Mansfield Air National Guard landed at 10:47 pm.

The object thus appears not to have been any kind of conventional aircraft.

The Meteor Hypothesis

A meteor, by commonly accepted definition, is the luminosity produced by the friction of air resistance as a meteoroid (a material particle) hurtles through the atmosphere, exciting and ionizing atoms along its path.

Appearance. A meteor trail is by its very nature diffuse and luminous. It does not appear opaque, blotting out the background of stars, or possess a precisely delineated structure, as was reported by the witnesses in the helicopter and on the ground. The red, white, and green lights were reported in precise positions on the object's structure. There were no reports of a diffuse, overall luminescence, trail effect, or lingering after-image. Even Jezzi, who reported only an intense white light, reported no trail or general luminosity other than that from the concentrated light source itself.

Motion. The components of the object's motions are discussed in detail on page 63. Obviously the flight path of the object, with its rapid approach, deceleration, hovering and departure at moderate speed as reported by both crew and ground witnesses, does not qualify as meteor behavior. A meteor, if very slow, if in orbit many tens of kilometers above the helicopter, and if (most importantly) it could "keep itself alive," would appear to climb halfway across the sky during the first increment alone; it would not maintain the same position on the horizon. (Witness the path of an artificial satellite as it crosses the celestial sphere.) Any object moving across the observer's line of sight at a constant speed will appear to move most rapidly as it crosses directly in front of, and is closest to, the observer.

If the object were an exceptionally bright fireball (suggesting that it was at considerable altitude and distance from the observers), the question is raised why it was not reported, that clear balmy evening, by numerous observers as it passed so leisurely over the several-hundred-mile path of Pennsylvania, Ohio, Indiana, or Michigan, or even out over Lake Erie, where in the starry darkness dozens of ore freighter seamen must have been at the watch. To our knowledge, no bright meteors were reported at all that night over the many thousands of square miles from which the object--had it been at high altitude--would have been visible.

Duration. Meteors are short-lived phenomena. Once a meteor has entered the earth's atmosphere, its fiery flight can endure for only a very few seconds. Average shower meteors are visible for less than two seconds; fireballs and bolides rarely last more than ten seconds (Kroniv, 1960). The Orionid meteor shower (associated with the orbit of Halley's Comet) which occurs every year between October 18-23, is a relatively minor meteor shower characterized by swift streaks, persistent trains, and velocities of about 40 miles per second.

Meteors "ignite" and become visible at altitudes from 100 km down to about 80 km (60 to 50 mi.). For an observer essentially at sea level, objects between 80 and 100 km (60 and 80 mi.) could theoretically be visible over flight paths from 720 to 1150 km (446 to 713 mi.) in radius. For meteors at the altitude of 80 km (50 mi.), an Orionid at 66 km/sec (41 mi.) could theoretically cross the sky in less than 22 seconds; a sporadic meteor traveling

at the average meteor velocity of 40 km/sec (25 mi.) could traverse the entire sky in less than 36 seconds, and an extremely slow fireball with a velocity of 12 km/sec (7.4 mi.) could theoretically cross the entire visible sky in about 110 seconds.

But theory and reality are not always compatible. All of the above figures are based upon the premises that a meteor head could maintain its altitude of entry, could stay in a circular orbit without decay, and could continue to burn without disintegration, for more than 2300 km (1400 mi.).

Empirical evidence corroborated by radar measurements indicate that these phenomena do not occur. Meteors are not observed to travel 180° from horizon to horizon. Faint (shower) meteors have a usual path length of only about 60 km (87 mi.); bright meteors may have a path length of up to 300 km (186 mi.) (Flammarion, 1964), but in fact, to be visible they must be within 150 to 200 km (90 to 125 mi.) of the observer. Angular velocities average about 20° per second (Olivier, 1925).

I consulted extensively on this problem with Dr. William M. Protheroe, Professor of Astronomy, Ohio State University, who supplied the formulae and checked their application to the flight times of meteors. Dr. Hynek also considered this problem. Their conclusion is that the generally accepted time for longest meteor head visibility, under the most favorable conditions, would be on the order of 30 to 40 seconds.

Thus the appearance of the object, the nature of its motion, and the length of time it remained visible all provide grave difficulties for a meteor hypothesis as an explanation for the reported events.

CHAPTER III

ANOMALIES WITHIN THE AIRCRAFT

While the men of the helicopter crew were watching the object in astonishment and fear, they were also experiencing certain anomalies within the aircraft. First the radios abruptly malfunctioned on all frequencies, then they noticed that the magnetic compass disk was rotating, and finally, as the object moved to the west of their aircraft, they discovered they were in a 1000 fpm climb with the collective full down.

The Radio Malfunction

As the object/light approached the helicopter, first Coyne and then Jezzi attempted to make radio contact with the Mansfield Control Tower to check possible aircraft in the area.

Zeidman: Now, on this business of the radio, the apparent radio malfunction. . . .

Coyne: That's the problem. Now Jezzi was calling while I was handling the aircraft. Jezzi called on this radio, the VHF. There was no answer. He depressed the mike. You'd hear the keying sound, and you'd hear him talking on the air through your own earphones, but then there was nothing coming back.

Zeidman: The keying sound indicates that you are transmitting?

Coyne: Right. Then he changed frequencies, and called on the alternate. He called Tower on VHF, then he called on UHF. The frequencies are published in the IFR. He

had the IFR supplement in his hand, and we heard the channel tone every time he changed frequencies, the channel tone and the keying sound. The radios were functioning, but we had no transmission. They weren't receiving us.

Zeidman: Okay. Now, the channeling tone. . . .

Coyne: When you change like this [click, click] you hear a channeling tone, every time you change channels.

Zeidman: And it lasts a second or so?

Coyne: Right, a couple seconds or less.

Zeidman: And it indicates that you have changed frequencies?

Coyne: And when you hit the mike you hear the keying sound.

Zeidman: Now, there are two ways to activate the mike. . . .

Coyne: Right. Here [a heel pedal] and here [the mike button on the cyclic stick]. And yet we had perfect transmission with Canton/Akron after, and with Columbus prior, and with Cleveland when we landed. And Mansfield was just eight miles away. [See map, p. 18.]

Zeidman: The shortest distance of all.

Coyne: Right. We could see over there.

Certainly Mansfield was well within radio range, and previous contact with the Tower had been no problem. According to Coyne, no exactly comparable malfunction of this specific aircraft's radios had occurred, either before or after the October 18 incident.

Coyne reported that the day following the event, he phoned the Mansfield Tower and asked that they replay the previous night's tapes. As Coyne told Dr. Hynek, "They said they heard us and yet they say they can't find it on the tapes." There is no record of even the initial transmission between the helicopter and the Tower.

In many UFO encounters, pilots have reported a temporary failure of aircraft radios, instruments, or sometimes total electrical systems. A sampling of such incidents is summarized in Chapter IV. See especially the reports dated June 1948, September 1950, February 1955, June 1967, November 1967, and June 1968 for examples of malfunctioning radios. Reports of the temporary failure of whole electrical systems are recounted in the events dated December 1956, August 1957, September 1968, and September 1976.

Dr. Richard Haines, psychologist-physicist, has commented, "Ionized air is known to block radio transmission, as evidenced by numerous studies. A well-known example occurs during a spacecraft re-entry during ablation of the heat shield when all communication is lost."

Could this have caused the radio silence?

The Compass Rotation

At the most intense moment of the encounter, after the helicopter had dived to avoid a collision and after the beam of green light had penetrated the cockpit, the magnetic compass began rotating slowly (see pages 17 and 34), while the RMI (radio magnetic indicator) remained apparently unaffected.

The magnetic compass, most basic of navigation instruments, is a simple device consisting of one central unit on which two bar magnets are fastened on a two-point suspension system which is permitted to rotate freely in response to local variations in magnetic field (see inset, page 81). As the plane changes direction, the compass heading is read directly from a disk which rotates around a pivot. The magnetic compass is acutely sensitive to changes in the plane's attitude (turning, banking) and is subject to error (but not to the extent of continuous rotation), unless the aircraft is in straight and level, constant-speed flight. The instrument also reacts to ferrous metals or electrical currents in the vicinity (as evidenced by Coyne's mention that the compass would deviate by 20° when the aircraft's landing lights were turned on), and for this reason it is placed as far as possible away from such potential disturbances in the cockpit (see Figure 19). Every aircraft has its own residual magnetic fields that are balanced out at the time of installation of a magnetic compass.

Figure 19. View of Instrument Panel
(with Compass Obstructed by Cyclic)

81

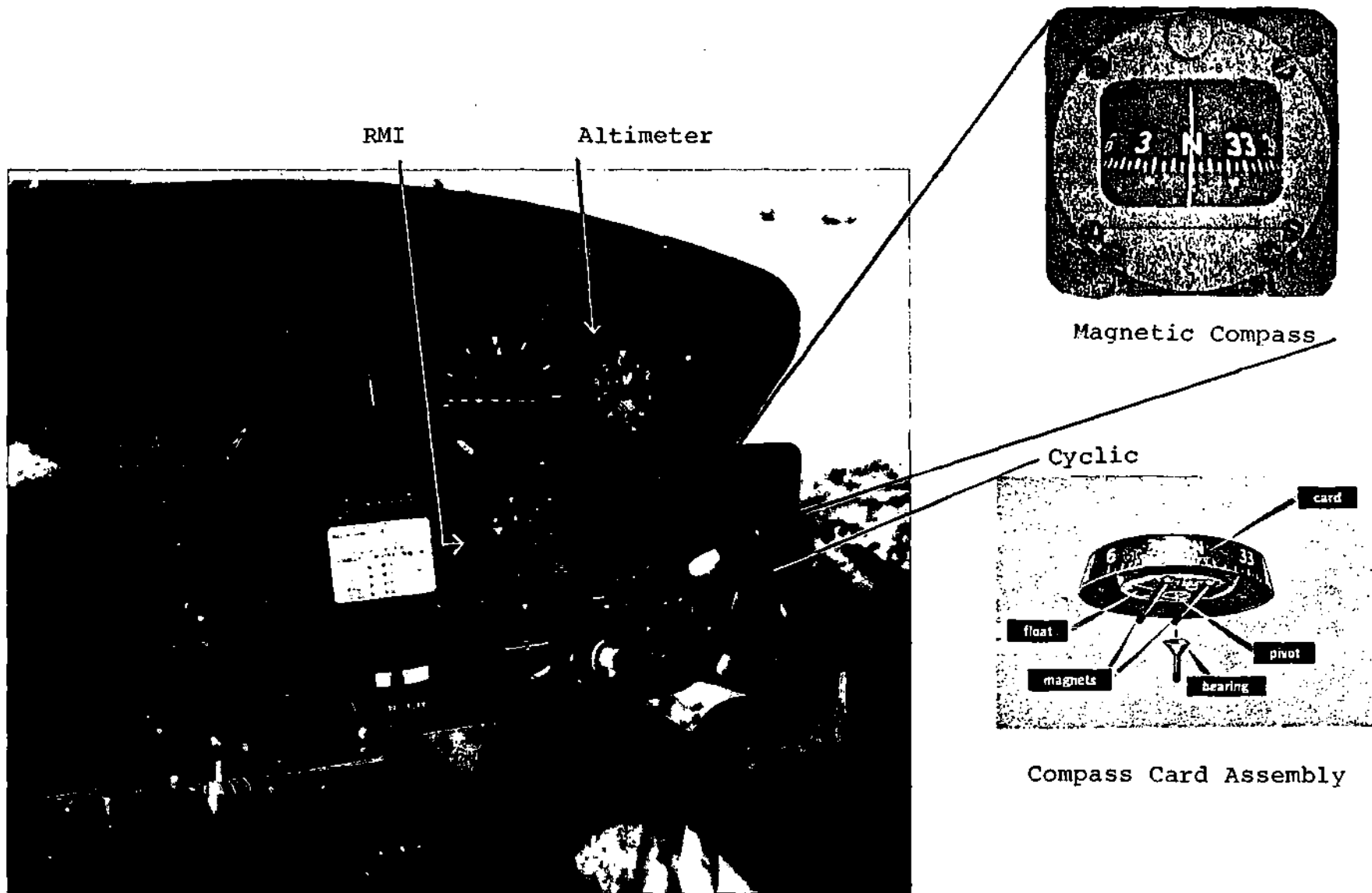


Photo by Hynek

The RMI (in this case, an AN/ASN-43 built by the Sperry Gyroscope Co.) is a multi-purpose instrument used with three different navigation systems: a DG (directional gyrocompass), the ADF (automatic direction finder), and the VOR (very-high-frequency omni-direction range). The RMI "clock-face" is itself only an indicator, and is capable of presenting simultaneous readings from all three systems. The remote sensor for the DG portion of the system is located in the tail boom of the UH-1 helicopter and consists of an induction compass transmitter and a magnetic flux compensator. The gyro itself is located in the aft radio compartment. Only through the DG mode could the instrument be affected by changes in the magnetic field. Coyne reported that all three modes were operational at the time of the encounter.

The head of the avionics laboratory at the helicopter maintenance facility has commented:

If the directional gyro (DG) system were subjected to a disturbance or variation in magnetic field, it would not respond with any drastic needle swinging on the instrument face, but by displaying either a "+" or "-" symbol located in a small synchronization knob located at one corner of the instrument. Under the circumstances [the excitement of the encounter] , such an error indication could easily be missed by the pilots.

Guidance and control specialist Dr. Robert Wood has speculated:

If an aircraft were subjected to a strong transient magnetic field, it could change the aircraft's own

residual magnetic signature, resulting in deviation of the magnetic compass. In the encounter with the UFO, since the compass made about four complete rotations per minute, the local magnetic field (at the compass itself) apparently modulated at that rate. However, a pulsating magnetic field emanating from the unknown object that could cause a compass rotation at the time of the encounter would not explain the continued rotation into the next day, unless the friction in the compass bearings was extremely low.

In response to questions raised by Jezzi's testimony (page 34), Coyne stated that the magnetic compass had never malfunctioned previously, and that although the replacement compass did not function properly, this was finally attributed to faulty installation. When it was re-installed, there was no further trouble with the instrument.

The Unexpected Ascent

The highest elevations in the SE Mansfield area are 1300 feet above sea level. Coyne reported that as the red light approached and a collision appeared imminent, the last altitude he noted was 1700 feet, with a 2000 fpm dive in progress. However, we know from the location of the ground witnesses that the site is lower than the surrounding hills--the lake elevation is 997 feet--and the trees near the shore are approximately 30-50 feet high. The 1700-foot altitude thus reflected on actual above-the-trees level of perhaps 650 to 670 feet.

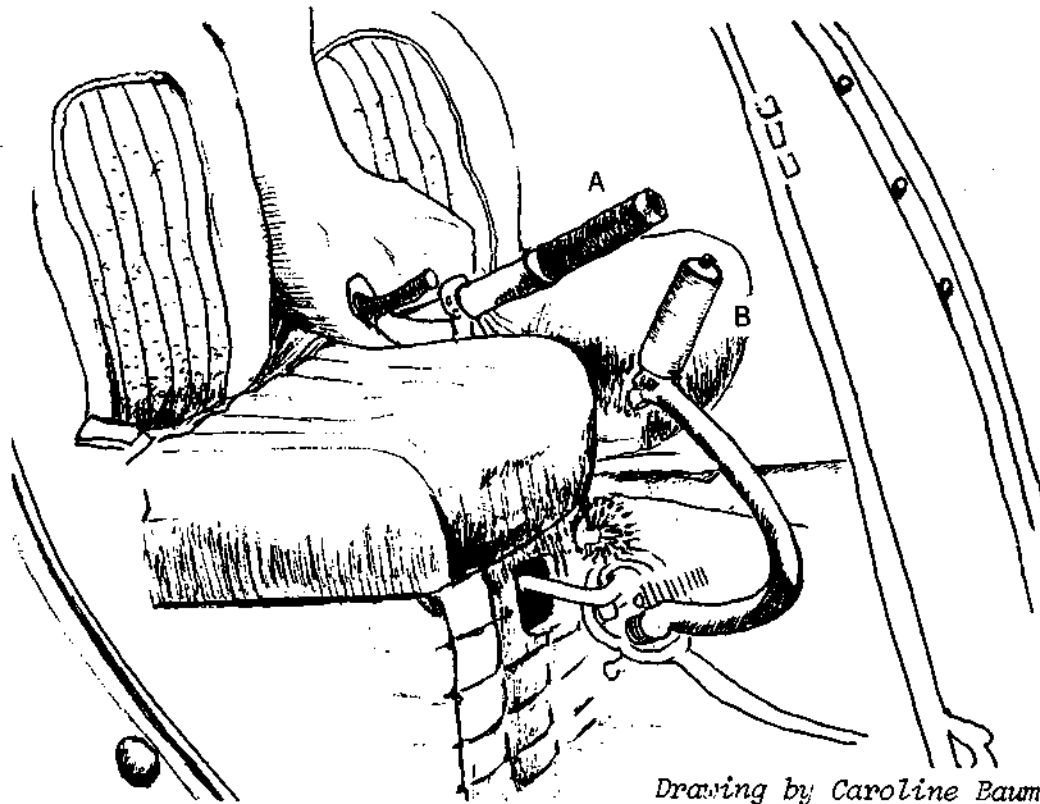
"The reason I didn't crash into the ground," Coyne told me, "was because I could see the ground. I had night vision. We were down to 500 feet, maybe. But I've flown a helicopter low-level many times--200 feet, even 50 feet. The big thing of course is wires, obstructions."

We do not know at what precise altitude the helicopter ceased diving and began to climb. There are two reasons to suspect that the dive-to-climb change was not an abrupt one: none of the crew felt the g-forces of a sudden directional change (yet they were all acutely aware of the dive) and the ground witnesses reported that the two craft were maintaining the same altitude while the two children got out of the car.

Coyne says that the collective was in the full down position when he noticed the climb, the cyclic in a "nose-down 20°" position (out of a 40° nose-down capability), and his power setting had never been changed at all from the cruising setting of 6600 rpm.

"It was 3500 feet when I noticed it," [the climb] Coyne said, and this [the collective] was still bottomed. No lift. I didn't have that much time to think. Something not normal was happening. It continued to the point where we topped out at 3800 feet."

Figure 20. SIDE VIEW OF A HELICOPTER'S COLLECTIVE AND CYCLIC CONTROLS



- A. Collective--controls altitude
- B. Cyclic--controls attitude and direction of flight

Coyne remembers that his left arm was stiff (elbow straight) on the collective. When I pointed out (during the April 2, 1978 review meeting at Port Columbus) that if he had been reared back looking upward through the "greenhouse," he could have maintained

a stiff arm and still have been pulling up on the collective, Yanacsek immediately broke in and said that he remembered definitely that Coyne, seated directly in front of him, had been hunched over in a protective, flinching posture, not reared back. Coyne agreed, remembering how he instinctively stiffened and flinched in anticipation of a collision, and how his attention had been focused primarily to the front, not upward through the "greenhouse."

Coyne's description of the abnormal control response and the concurrence of all four crewmen that they were unaware of both climb and g-forces remain among the most puzzling aspects of this event. Their testimony should be compared with that of South African pilot Anton Fitzgerald (see page 92) who describes two incidents in which he experienced abnormal aircraft ascents without awareness of g-forces, in a fixed-wing aircraft, while unexplained aerial phenomena were present. Irrespective of similar events, however, the implication of the Coyne crew testimony is that the helicopter's climb was not a normal one.

CHAPTER IV

SIMILAR EVENTS

The helicopter-UFO incident, while unique in its particular combination of aspects, still showed certain similarities to other encounters of aircraft with UFOs. Some of those are summarized in this chapter.

The Same Evening

Walter and Mary Kowalchik live SW of Mansfield in a hilly, wooded, suburban area. On October 18, 1973, they were talking on the local network of their Ham radio group at about 9 pm with Richard Swain, a Technical Sergeant in the Air Force, who was in Galion, Ohio (see Figure 21). Kowalchik reported:

Swain said, "There's something strange. First of all, it's a strange light. No airplane has a light like that. It's an orange glow, rather than a flashing red or green. And secondly," he said, "it isn't behaving like an aircraft. Now wait a minute, there's something strange here!" And he was all excited. He was in Galion and he said it was heading towards Shelby.

Now it so happens that Mr. Eldon Heck was also on the air, and he sent his wife out in the yard to scan the skies while he was on the air. Sure enough, she came back to report that she was sighting something strange

over the Shelby area. It was heading towards Mansfield. So we have a report from Galion, we have a report from Shelby, and then we have a report from Gordon Sponseller who was also in the Air National Guard, and he said, "There is a strange object. I can't identify it because all I can see is a light. I cannot see an object, but I can see a strange light, and the manner in which it is maneuvering--it's very rapidly in one direction and then a sudden stop." Sponseller said that no object with any mass at all could possibly stop that suddenly. "Something is strange," he said. "Either someone is shining a light against some clouds, or it's a type of maneuvering that is very fast."

And by that time I [Kowalchik] came out here and told Mary, because at that time we had a very clear view of the sky in that direction. At that time there were no leaves on that dogwood tree. We had a very clear view of the skyline, and Mary said, "Well now, I do see an orange glow over there," but she also sighted an aircraft in the sky, and she knew it was an aircraft because of the flashing lights on the craft, and it was moving at a very steady rate across the sky like an airplane would, whereas the other object was moving very rapidly from spot to spot on the skyline. So Mary called me out and as I got there she said, "Look at that! Oh my God, they're gonna crash!" Because they were on a collision course--at least it appeared from here, and they did come close together and veered off--the orange object veered off, and the plane kept going on, and that's about the extent of our sighting.

Mrs. Kowalchik then gave her version of the incident:

I watched it with the binoculars and I kept track of it. We've seen other lights, unidentified lights, in other parts of the sky, but this one seemed to be staying and staying in one place for the longest time, and finally

I came to the conclusion that it couldn't possibly be a plane. When I did see the plane come, the two of them seemed to come right together. I really let out a scream because it looked from here--of course that was a ways away--but the way I could see them with the binoculars it looked like they were coming right into each other. The two of them seemed to be coming right toward each other. It seemed that way because the object had seemed to sit in the sky for a long time before.

I asked Mrs. Kowalchik what the object did after the the apparent close approach.

"It was visible for a little while, then it seemed to suddenly disappear. I could see the plane going off."

"Was the aircraft a fixed-wing plane or a helicopter?"

"I really don't know. It seemed that the plane kept on its course."

Mr. Kowalchik interrupted. "As near as I can recall, the plane continued on the course, but the glow or the light veered upward suddenly. The plane was at a fairly low altitude. It was just above the skyline. It appeared to be just beyond Mansfield, to the northeast."

Mrs. Kowalchik continued. "It was an orange glow, a very bright orange glow. It was definitely not a red. Also, it was a lot brighter than any airplane light. We can watch the planes, lots of times we watch, and even when they're close and the lights look larger--but this wasn't anything like that."

She went on to say, "It stayed in one area for a long time. I could tell from the relationship to the skyline and

to the dogwood tree. You know, I watch hummingbirds a lot. And they're so mobile, and I couldn't help but think how interesting that was, that the object was also so mobile. A helicopter couldn't do that."

I asked, "Did you see any meteors, any shooting stars?"

Mrs. Kowalchik replied, "Oh, I've seen meteors sometimes, but not that night. It wasn't anything like a shooting star, it really wasn't."

Mr. Kowalchik said, "I won't even attempt to offer any type of explanation for this, but there was an object. It was not any aircraft. Obviously not an aircraft because no aircraft could possibly move in this fashion where it would hover, be stationary, then move very quickly. And particularly near the near collision--it seemed to rise straight up in the air. I can't remember how it disappeared, just faded away."

"I know the plane went on its way," Mrs. Kowalchik added, "because I felt such a great sense of relief, because obviously nothing had happened."

Referring to his Ham log, Mr. Kowalchik established that the sighting occurred on October 18, 1973. The net started at 7:30 pm and they were off the air at 9:30. The incident happened during the later part of the time interval, about 9:00 pm.

Obviously, this was not the helicopter encounter which occurred at 11:05 pm. Obviously, too, without other witnesses on the ground or a report from the pilot, there is no way of knowing if the plane and the object did nearly collide. In the

Figure 21. AREA AROUND MANSFIELD



In reference to another incident on the same evening,
Dr. Hynek received this letter.

11-14-77

Dr. Hynek:

While reading the Nov. '77 Reader's Digest article on UFO's I came across an incident that I was a small part of. Perhaps I should have written sooner while facts were still fresh but this is my mistake. The Reference is to the sighting over Mansfield, Ohio on October 18, 1973 by a Capt. Lawrence Coyne. Below is my observation.

I was the First Officer on an American Airlines flight 21, a Boeing 747, enroute from New York Kennedy to Los Angeles Int'l, on October 18, 1973. We departed Kennedy at 1800 EST. At a point on the airway approximately in the vicinity of Rosewood, Ohio*, at approximately 1930 EST an air carrier aircraft (either United or TWA) eastbound at 35,000 feet called Cleveland Center to inquire of the traffic directly ahead of him. Cleveland responded they had no traffic in that area nor were painting any on their radar.

Another Air Carrier (again I can't remember the sequence of calls, except that United, TWA & Delta were involved in the transmissions) who I remember gave his flight level at 37,000 ft and was westbound also reported sighting traffic in the same area ahead and below his flight level. Another Air Carrier called in and also verified traffic in the same area. It was dark on the ground but at our flight level (33,000) it was still fairly light. I turned to my right and looked to the rear (northeast) and sighted an object which I can only describe as concave in shape which illuminated a bluish green light, enough so as to mask the actual shape of the

* See Fig. 1.

object. The best way I could describe it is like looking at a black light where all edge definition falls off.

My actual sighting was very brief as the object slid out of vision behind the cockpit rear window. Whether it was our forward movement or its [sic]

It was only later that year when watching a Dick Cavett telecast on UFO's did I realize the consequences of what might have occurred.

My conclusions of what I saw is that there was an object, not a meteor as Mr. Phillip Klass speculates, because of the triangulation of the aircraft, and also the vertical scale (i.e. above some, below others). Also the time differential. Ours was sighted at approximately 1930 EST and I believe Capt. Coyne sighted theirs at approximately 2200 EST, which is a pretty long time for a fireball to hang around.

I have never filed a UFO sighting before but in 18 years of flying aircraft, this was the strangest thing I have ever seen. If I can be of any further assistance please call on me. Sorry I took so long.

Respectfully,

Gary Buckland
First Officer, American Airlines
Los Angeles, California

Similar Events on Other Occasions

The reports in this section of UFO sightings associated with aircraft exhibit some of the same features as those of the helicopter incident discussed here. Most of these reports come from UFOCAT, the computerized index developed by Dr. David Saunders, which contains over 63,000 UFO and UFO-related reports. Another source is the personal collection of over 3,000 UFO sightings by pilots compiled by Dr. Richard F. Haines. Both were asked only for reports in which electro-magnetic effects or anti-gravity effects had been described. There are many more accounts of such effects in existence. These are a representative selection to indicate the scope of the phenomenon; not all have received a first-hand investigation or analysis. They are arranged chronologically.

A South African pilot with considerable flying experience, and two additional witnesses, reported that on a calm, misty morning while on the ground they observed a reddish glow or "bubble" about 200 yards away and 1,000 feet in diameter which appeared to be resting on an airport runway. The "bubble" started to rise vertically, and all the sheep in an adjacent paddock rose "on tiptoe like ballet dancers, suspended in space with their hooves barely touching the grass."

The pilot and his companion now also experienced personal sensations of weightlessness as they started to run toward the "bubble."

A short time later, while he was taking off on the same runway in an Aero Commander, the pilot found that the aircraft "left the ground like a flash," ascended through the overcast, and "within a couple of seconds

[we] were out in the clear on top of the stratus. The vertical speed needle was hard up against the maximum rate of climb stop, while the altimeter needle was spinning clockwise." There was no awareness of G-force. A ground observer corroborated the unusual take-off and climb.

A year later, in Texas, the same witness and a companion had a similar experience just after dawn while flying at 22,000 feet in a MU2 turboprop. A circular object with "the same eerie pinkish glow" shot straight up onto the sky directly ahead of the aircraft's flight path. The glow of the rising sun was behind them. The aircraft was put into a 3,000 fpm descent with reduced power. As 10,000 feet was reached, the "vertical speed needle moved rapidly from descent to against the maximum rate-of-climb stop, while the altimeter needle reversed direction and started spinning clockwise at an incredible rate." As in the previous experience, no g-force was felt. The anomaly lasted only for a few seconds, yet the aircraft reached 25,000 feet before control was regained.

Upon landing, they found that a rancher 70 miles away had just witnessed a like phenomenon (to the first event) on his runway with similar unusual behavior of steers who were corralled nearby. (Anton Fitzgerald, "Repeat Performance," FSR, May-June 1969, Maidstone, England, p. 6)

On July 23, 1947 a lone pilot at 6,000 feet noticed a bright shaft of light which appeared to beam down near his plane from a higher altitude. Total engine failure ensued; however, the nose of his plane "instead of dropping to a normal glide, remained rigidly fixed on the horizon, in normal, level flight altitude." The airspeed indicator dropped to zero. The pilot experienced prickling, electric-like sensations, and felt that he "was being

watched and examined." Then he noticed a dull metallic-like port-holed structure about a quarter of a mile away, and beyond it "another disk, seemingly fixed in the sky." Soon afterwards the pilot was able to restart his engine and his aircraft behaved normally. (Harold T. Wilkins, Flying Saucers on the Attack, New York: Ace Books, 1954, p. 70, quoting John Jenssen)

A Soviet test pilot, A.I. Apraksin, had two similar UFO experiences. On June 16, 1948, while flying above the clouds, a "cucumber" shaped object was seen emitting "cones of beams," which opened up like a fan and burned his machine, blinding him for an instant and causing malfunctions of electrical controls of the plane and engine. The object "jerked upward" into a cloud layer.

On May 6, 1949 Apraksin, again solo, observed another "flying cucumber." Again a cone of beams was directed toward his plane; his vision was affected, and the entire electrical portion of the controls were destroyed. Radio communications ceased, and there was damage to the aircraft window and the cockpit pressurization systems. (Felix Zigel, "Unidentified Flying Objects in the U.S.S.R." photocopied; Evanston, Ill.: Center for UFO Studies Library, p. 124)

Just after dawn in Korea, September 1950, two large circular shadows were observed racing along the ground. The radar gunner, flying in a US carrier-based fighter-bomber, looked up and saw the objects responsible for the shadows. "They were huge . . . at least 600-700 feet in diameter . . . traveling 1,000 to 1,200 mph . . . with a 'silvered mirror' appearance. . . . A reddish glow surrounded them . . . shaped somewhat like a coolie's hat, with oblong ports from which emanated a copper-green

colored light. The middle of the underside was coal black. The objects were also visible on the aircraft radar.

These objects "suddenly seemed to halt, back up, and begin a 'jittering'. . . motion." The aircraft guns (with attached cameras) jammed and the radar went haywire. Radio communications with the aircraft carrier and with two other frequencies also jammed. The objects maneuvered around, over and below the three-plane flight, and were observed by all crewmen. (Coral Lorenzen, Flying Saucers: The Startling Evidence of the Invasion from Outer Space, New York: New American Library, 1962, p. 30)

On February 2, 1955, on a clear day at 7,500 feet, an experienced Aeropost airliner pilot, Captain Dario Celis, and his co-pilot observed a round, green-lighted, rotating object emitting flashes of red light which rapidly approached the plane. When the pilot attempted to inform the nearest ground radio stations--Barquisimeto and Valera, Venezuela--of the unidentified object, the communication failed as soon as he began transmitting, but resumed after the rapid disappearance of the object. (Donald E. Keyhoe, The Flying Saucer Conspiracy, New York: Holt & Co., 1955, p. 249)

On December 17, 1956, near Itazuke AFB, Japan, a USAF jet pilot picked up a large unidentified radar blip which did not appear on ground radar. Receiving permission to intercept, the pilot closed in at over 700 mph. At 8 miles range, a round object became visible precisely where the radar showed it. The object was golden tan, non-reflective, and appeared to be circular on the bottom. A diameter of approximately 350 feet was computed from the object's apparent size on the windshield vs. known distance. Auto-

matic radar lock-on was achieved; however, as the pilot continued to close, the radar was intermittently jammed by strong interference. He approached to within 5 NM before the object began moving away at speeds of 1,500 to 1,800 kts. Immediately after landing, the jet and its equipment were checked and all systems found satisfactory. (Richard Hall (Ed.), The UFO Evidence, Washington, D.C.: National Investigations Committee for Aerial Phenomena (NICAP), 1964)

At 8:55 am on August 14, 1957, the crew of a Varig C-47 cargo plane, enroute from Porto Alegre in southern Brazil to Rio de Janeiro, observed above a thick cloud layer, a luminous, saucer-shaped, domed object which made several abrupt rapid horizontal maneuvers and then dived into the clouds below. The object's dome glowed with an intense green light; the flattened base showed a less intense yellowish light. During the closest approach of the airliner, the C-47's engines ran roughly and the cabin lights and other electrical systems malfunctioned. After the object's disappearance, the aircraft systems returned to normal. (Lorenzen, 1962, p. 155)

On November 4, 1957 at 1:20 am, the ADF, right generator, and transmitter-receiver of a Varig C-46, flying above a cloud layer near Ararangua, Brazil, burned out simultaneously when an unidentified red light "suddenly leaped through an arc of about 45 degrees" and began to "increase in size" and glow brilliantly. (Hall, 1964)

In December 1966 a Finnair pilot flying a two-engine jet aircraft at 25,000 feet altitude encountered three dark, cigar-shaped objects on about a 30° heading. As

this formation passed him, his compass comparator light came on indicating that the two independent instruments were more than 5° out of correspondence. Both compasses returned to the same reading (normal) when the formation moved ahead. After the plane landed, both RMIs were inspected and found to be functioning normally. Subsequent flights over the same area produced no similar effects. The visual phenomena were also seen by another Finnair pilot over Hamburg, Germany, as well as by two other SAS pilots who reported them to Stockholm Control. Some 400 ground witnesses reported seeing what is likely the same phenomena also. (Dr. Richard Haines, personal collection of sightings made by pilots of aircraft)

On June 9, 1967 two Spanish Air Force pilots in separate T-33 jets chased an unidentified object at an altitude of 3,900 feet over the province of Extremadura. The object appeared to wait for them to approach, then moved on again. Whenever they were directly above or below the object, their radios malfunctioned, merely emitting noises resembling the interference associated with storms.

Two additional faster jets were scrambled to the scene; those four crewmen experienced the same conditions of "cat and mouse game," and radio malfunction. Finally the object shot upwards at exceedingly great velocity and disappeared. (Antonio Ribera, "Spanish Jets Chase UFO," FSR, May-June 1968, p. 26)

An aircraft's radio, cockpit lights, and passenger cabin lights were reported to have dimmed on November 16, 1967 at 1822 hours over Peru when two UFOs, shaped like a child's top, circled the plane, a DC-4. The captain, first officer, and some of the passengers saw the objects.

One object remained near the plane, flying at 7,000 feet, for about 60 minutes. When it disappeared, the lights came back on to their normal intensity. Several minutes later, as the captain was radioing Lima, the UFOs returned with another similar object. They "hovered about the plane only for a short period, and then both sped away." The radio and lights operated normally during this second encounter. (Haines, personal collection)

Still another possible UFO-induced electromagnetic interference case occurred on a clear day, June 18, 1968, near La Guardia, Argentina. This encounter was somewhat similar to that reported by the Coyne crew. The pilot and his passenger saw a greyish-blue UFO, estimated to be about 30 m. in diameter, and appearing like an "over-turned soup plate," at about 7,500 feet altitude, 1625 hours local time. It approached the aircraft from the right side and was estimated to be about 1,000 m. away. The pilot tried unsuccessfully to use his VHF radio to contact Cordoba Air Control but made a faint communication with Catamarca Control Tower, and a successful contact with Flight 713 of Aerolineas Argentinas.

The UFO "placed itself in front of the plane." Seconds after, it disappeared towards the north at a fantastic speed. The pilot was then able to contact the Catamarca Control Tower. Moments later, the UFO reappeared "at an incredible speed towards the plane. It . . . only stopped at a few meters in front of the plane. It began to wobble and seconds later it disappeared towards the north again at a fantastic speed. Both sightings lasted between two and three minutes." (Haines, personal collection)

A glowing object, traveling fast and maneuvering rapidly, was seen near an airliner enroute from San Juan, Argentina to Buenos Aires on September 29, 1968. The object changed directions and went up and down several times. The pilot reported that the electrical equipment on the aircraft went completely dead. The object speeded up and disappeared, and the electrical equipment returned to normal. (Bill Burt, "Amazing UFO Sightings in Argentina," The National Enquirer, October quoting Captain A. Martin C.)

In March, 1971 a pilot in Ontario sighted a very large bullet-shaped object which "flashed into view from the East, seemed to stop directly in front of the Beaver aircraft, and then flash away almost instantaneously" at 2 pm on a clear day. A reddish-grey flame was at the rear of the bright silver, smooth object. The aircraft's engine stopped and then started again after the UFO left, according to the former bush pilot with 22 years of experience. There was even some possible evidence for a time lapse (or at least concentration by the pilot leading to some mental confusion). (Haines, personal collection)

On March 18, 1972, an AUA (Austrian Airlines) DC-9, enroute from Vienna to Frankfurt in a clear sky at 7:18 pm, experienced a direction-finding system breakdown. "The two ADF radio-compasses showed an aberration of 8° against each other." Five minutes later, a "huge white funnel" or inverted cone was observed motionless in the sky, with its axis pointing downward and beams of light visible from the top.

After two minutes the object began moving. The light changed from white to red, and the bottom of the object,

shaped like an ellipse, seemed to expand; a halo effect was observed which seemed to originate from a distinct white ring clearly outlined against the sky. After the object "dashed away" in a straight trajectory, leaving an "ionized trail--a luminous path of whitish-reddish gas glowing for 20 minutes," the radio compasses returned to normal. A Lufthansa pilot enroute to Stuttgart, also observed the object and also experienced direction-finding system anomalies. There is further corroboration by a third airliner and numerous ground witnesses.

(Alexander Keul, "UFO Sightings in Austria," in APRO Bulletin, Aerial Phenomena Research Organization, March-April 1972, Tucson, Ariz., quoting Captain Alexander Raab)

On February 2, 1973, a (Canadian) Air North airline pilot reported seeing a circular ball, self-luminous, 20-40 feet in diameter at about 30 yards from the aircraft for about 20-25 seconds over Ontario. It approached the plane from the west, lit up the cockpit, and disappeared by accelerating into the distance. While the object was close to the plane, the pilot reported that the magnetic compass malfunctioned and the automatic direction finder (ADF) needles rotated aimlessly, while the VOR remained "locked on." The RMI needle rotated at several rpm for "quite some time" after the Aero Commander aircraft passed over a ground radio beacon. (Haines, personal collection)

Pilot Carlos de los Santos was flying between Zihuatanejo and Mexico City on the morning of May 3, 1974 when his Piper Aztec 24 was surrounded by three unidentified disk-like objects, one over each wing and one underneath his aircraft. The objects were three meters in diameter and 1.2 meters high. De los Santos attempted to maneuver

away from the objects but found he was unable to operate his controls or reduce his speed, and his landing gear would not extend. The pilot attributed an increase in altitude from 15,000 feet to 15,800 feet to the objects. One by one the objects flew off and the controls returned to normal. De los Santos, who maintained radio contact with Mexico City Tower throughout the incident, was later able to lower the gear manually and make a satisfactory landing. The Mexico City Terminal Radar Controller verified that an anomalous blip was seen near his aircraft at the time and location in question. (Coral Lorenzen (Ed.), "UFOs 'Escort' Mexican Aircraft," APRO Bulletin, August 1975)

On November 28, 1974, the pilot of an Aeronca Champion flying over Shabbona, Illinois at 11:43 am in bright haze, encountered a round solid-appearing object, white or dull silver, without openings or protrusions, which paced his plane at a ground speed of 75-80 mph, and an altitude of 2,500 feet for a minimum of ten seconds, then accelerated out of sight. He estimated the object to be about one-fourth mile away, 120 feet long, and 30 feet thick. Before seeing the object, the pilot noticed that his magnetic compass was rotating counter-clockwise at a rate of four to five revolutions per minute and continued so until the object was gone. (Dwight Connelly (Ed.), "Pilot Says Compass Affected," Skylook the UFO Monthly, April 1975, Quincy, Ill.)

After citizens reported strange objects in the sky over Tehran, an F-4 jet of the Iranian Air Force pursued a brilliant white moving light at 0130 on September 19, 1976. As the plane approached to within 25 NM of the object, it lost the function of its UHF and intercom,

as well as its instrumentation. When the pilot broke off the chase and turned away, the instruments resumed functioning.

A second jet was scrambled and the pilot obtained a radar lock on the object by which means he estimated the size as that of a 707 tanker. When a second object/light emerged from the first and headed directly toward the pursuing plane, the crew attempted to fire a missile at it but were unable to operate the weapons control system, and lost all communications as well. After the pilot turned away and dived in evasive action, he saw the second object rejoin the first. His communications and weapons control systems resumed functioning.

Still another object emerged from the first and descended so rapidly that the aircrew expected a crash, but it only landed gently on a dry lake bed, casting a brilliant light over a wide area. Further radio interference and instrument malfunctions were reported by the F-4 and by a civil airliner passing through the same area. (Allan Hendry (Ed.), "The U.S. Government and the Iran Case," International UFO Reporter, January 1978, Evanston, Ill., quoting a message sent by the U.S. Department of Defense to various U.S. governmental agencies)

CHAPTER V

CONCLUSION

The object encountered by the Coyne helicopter crew remains unidentified despite many hours of face-to-face interviews with the observers and many months of supplementary investigation, consultation, and analysis. All of the witnesses were cooperative over extended periods of time. Because the aircrew and ground witnesses (who have never communicated with each other) reported substantially the same description and chronology, the probability is very high that they were participants in the same event. Certainly there is no indication of collusion or hoax among them, and independently of one another, the testimony of each set of witnesses represents a valid UFO experience.

The possibilities that the object was either a meteor or a high-performance aircraft have been considered at length and have been shown to be untenable. The degree to which the object affected the helicopter's instruments or flight path is unresolved although similar magnetic compass and radio malfunctions, as well as unexplained climbs and apparent near-collisions, have been recorded in other incidents of interaction between UFOs and aircraft.

One interpretation of the reported observations is that the phenomenon was an object with physical reality at the time of the sighting. Another possible interpretation could be that of a projected image, similar to that of a hologram.

I am not proposing any theory as to the mechanisms or the origins of UFO phenomena, or to the specific identity of this particular unknown object. This report offers only a presentation of the facts and my unswerving conviction that we are being confronted with new empirical data which deserve the serious attention of both behavioral and physical scientists.

SOURCES

	<u>Approximate Time Involved</u>
Zeidman face-to-face interviews:	
with <u>Coyne</u> : 6 interviews, 2 on tape	7 hours
with <u>Healey</u> : in the presence of Dr. Tom Evans, CUFOS psychologist consultant	2+ hours
with <u>Jezzi</u> : 2 hours in the presence of Dr. Hynek	5.5 hours
with <u>Yanacsek</u> : short portion on tape, remainder from handwritten notes	2 hours
with <u>ground witnesses</u> : 45 minutes on tape, at site	1.5 hours
with <u>Mr. and Mrs. Kowalchik</u> : (similar event 10/18/73 near Mansfield)	45 minutes
Review meeting: Coyne, Yanacsek and Healey (4/2/78 at Port Columbus)	1.5 hours
Other tapes available:	
Hynek with Coyne and Healey	2+ hours
Hynek with FAA people at Hopkins Field	30 minutes
Healey with colleague at Police Dept.	45 minutes
Healey with Laura Gallagher	1.5 hours
Healey on Susskind show	15+ minutes
Transcripts:	
Hynek with crew at dinner (notes)	
Nicholson/Jones with ground witnesses (2 two-hour tapes)	
Jones supplementary notes	
Consultation with Dr. Wm. M. Protheroe, Professor of Astronomy, Ohio State University	
Phone Conversations:	
Coyne (multiple); Healey; Jezzi; Air Hazard Office, Federal Aviation Authority, Port Columbus, Columbus, Ohio; members of the C. family	
Additional visits:	
Flight Service Station, Port Columbus; Weather Bureau, Port Columbus; Ohio Geological Survey Library; Physics Dept. Library, Ohio State University; Perkins Observatory Library, Ohio Wesleyan University	

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APPENDIX A

OPERATIONAL HAZARD REPORT

For use of this form, see AR 95-1; the proponent agency is Office of the Assistant Chief of Staff for Force Development.

(An operational hazard is any condition or act that affects or may affect the safe operation of Army aircraft, associated equipment, facilities, or cause injury to personnel.)

1. THIS HAZARD OCCURRED OR WAS OBSERVED WHILE:

a. ☒ IN-FLIGHT c. ☐ OTHER (specify) _____
b. ☐ ON THE GROUND d. ☐ LOCATED AT _____ DATE 18 OCT 73 HOUR 2300

2. THIS HAZARD IS CONCERNED WITH (select most appropriate category):

a. ☐ AIR TRAFFIC CONTROL c. ☐ WEATHER e. ☐ AIRCRAFT g. ☒ OTHER (specify) UNIDENTIFIED
b. ☐ AIRFIELD d. ☐ PUBLICATIONS f. ☐ PERSONNEL

3. IN THE AREA OF (select one or more to describe above category):

a. ☐ PROCEDURES/INSTRUCTIONS d. ☐ FACILITIES g. ☐ SERVICING (e.g., refueling)
b. ☐ POLICIES/REGULATIONS e. ☐ MAINTENANCE INSPECTION h. ☐ OTHER (specify) _____
c. ☐ OPERATION(S) f. ☐ SERVICE(S) (e.g., wx)

4. IF THIS HAZARD OCCURRED WHILE IN FLIGHT, COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING:

a. A/C TYPE UH-1H b. SERIAL NUMBER 68-15444 c. MISSION RETURNING FROM FLIGHT PHYSICALS
d. DEPARTED FROM COLUMBUS OHIO e. DESTINATION CLEVELAND OHIO

5. NEAREST NAVIGATION, FIX, FACILITY, OR AIRPORT

MANSFIELD AIRPORT EST DISTANCE WEST DIRECTION

6. YOUR AIRCRAFT WAS

☐ ON AIRWAYS ☐ OUTBOUND FROM AIRPORT
☐ OFF AIRWAYS ☐ INBOUND TO AIRPORT
☒ EN ROUTE ☐ POSITIVE CONTROL AIRSPACE
☐ TERMINAL ☐ OTHER (specify) _____
☐ IN CONTROL ZONE
☐ AIRPORT TRAFFIC PATTERN

7. YOUR AIRCRAFT OPERATING CONDITIONS

☒ VFR DD 178 ☐ IFR/VFR ON TOP
☐ VFR WITH IFR CLEARANCE ☐ DVFR/ADIZ FLIGHT LIMITS
☐ IFR DD 178 ☐ LOCAL
☐ IFR WITH NO CLEARANCE

IF THIS HAZARD WAS A NEAR MIDAIR COLLISION WITH ANOTHER AIRCRAFT OR OBSTACLE, COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING:

FIRST SIGHTING OTHER AIRCRAFT

OTHER AIRCRAFT/OBSTACLE OBSERVED AT 3 O'CLOCK
☐ ABOVE YOU ☐ DIVERGING ☐ YOUR RIGHT
☐ BELOW YOU ☐ CONVERGING ☐ YOUR LEFT
☒ SAME ALTITUDE ☐ YOU OVERTOOK ☐ OTHER OVERTOOK

WHAT FIRST DIRECTED ATTENTION TO THE OTHER AIRCRAFT/OBSTACLE?
RED LIGHT PARALLELING OUR ACFT.

DISTANCE BETWEEN AIRCRAFT/OBSTACLE

FIRST SIGHTING 8-10 mi. CLOSEST PROXIMITY 500 FT. HORIZONTAL _____ VERTICAL 500 FT.

PHASE OF FLIGHT

YOU	OTHER	PHASE	YOU	OTHER	PHASE
☐	☐	TAKEOFF	☐	☐	TURNING
☐	☐	CLIMB	☐	☐	REFUELING
☒	☒	LEVEL FLIGHT	☐	☐	ACROBATICS
☐	☐	DESCENDING	☐	☐	OTHER (specify) _____
☐	☐	LANDING			
☐	☐	HOLDING PATTERN			

FLIGHT ATMOSPHERIC CONDITIONS

☐ OVERCAST ☒ CLEAR ☐ BROKEN CLOUDS
☐ SCATTERED VISIBILITY MILES 15

CLOUD PROXIMITY

☐ ABOVE ☐ IN/OUT CLOUDS
☐ BELOW ☐ IN CLOUDS ☐ BETWEEN LAYERS

DISTANCE TO CLOUDS

HORIZONTAL _____ VERTICAL _____

FLIGHT CONDITIONS

☐ BRIGHT DAY ☐ DAWN ☐ HAZE
☐ GLARING SUN ☐ THUNDERSTORM ☐ ICING
☒ NIGHT ☐ PRECIPITATION ☐ FOG
☐ DUSK ☐ TURBULENCE

OTHER AIRCRAFT/OBSTACLE

TYPE A/C UNIDENTIFIED OBSTACLE DESCRIPTION _____

DESCRIPTION/EXPLANATION/COMMENTS (continue on reverse)

OBJECT APPROACHED AT SAME ALTITUDE FROM 8-10 MI. OUT, FROM THE EAST, FORCING ACFT. COMMANDER TO TAKE EVASIVE ACTION. OBJECT MADE NO ATTEMPT TO ALTER ITS FLIGHT PATH.

By (Your Aviation Safety Officer)

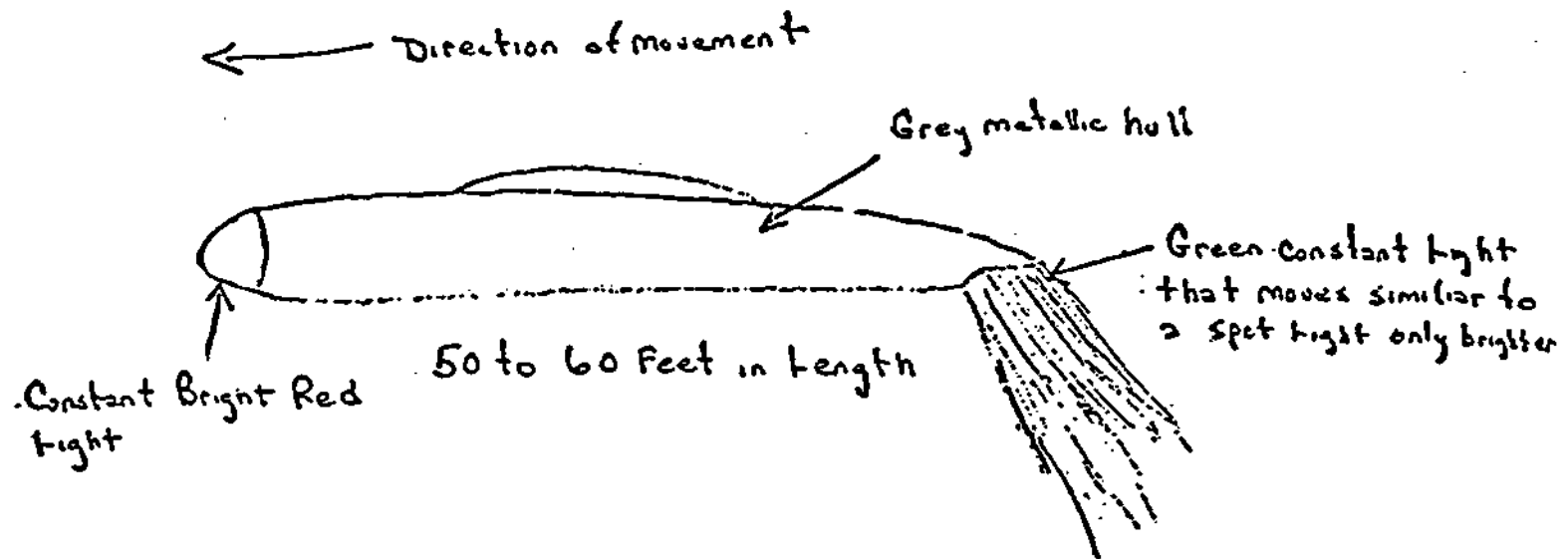
YOUR SIGNATURE (optional)

DUTY CREW CHIEF

DATE

Continuation Sheet to DA Form 2696, Item # 5

Obstacle Description: Continued



DISPOSITION FORM

For use of this form, see AR 340-15; the proponent agency is The Adjutant General's Office.

REFERENCE OR OFFICE SYMBOL

SUBJECT

Near Midair Collision with UFO Report

TO Commander
83D USARCOM
ATTN: AHRCCG
Columbus Support Facility
Columbus, Ohio 43245

FROM Flight Operations Off DATE 23 Nov 73 CMT 1
USAR Flight Facility
Cleveland Hopkins Airport
Cleveland, Ohio 44135

1. On 18 October 1973 at 2305 hours in the vicinity of Mansfield, Ohio, Army Helicopter 68-15444 assigned to Cleveland USARFFAC encountered a near midair collision with a unidentified flying object. Four crewmembers assigned to the Cleveland USARFFAC for flying proficiency were on AFTP status when this incident occurred. The flight crew assigned was CPT Lawrence J. Coyne, Pilot in Command, 1LT Arrigo Jozzi, Copilot, SSG Robert Yanacsek, Crew Chief, SSG John Healey, Flight Medic. All the above personnel are members of the 316th MED DET(HEL AMB), a tenant reserve unit of the Cleveland USARFFAC.

2. The reported incident happened as follows: Army Helicopter 68-15444 was returning from Columbus, Ohio to Cleveland, Ohio and at 2305 hours east, south east of Mansfield Airport in the vicinity of Mansfield, Ohio while flying at an altitude of 2500 feet and on a heading of 030 degrees, SSG Yanacsek observed a red light on the east horizon, 90 degrees to the flight path of the helicopter. Approximately 30 seconds later, SSG Yanacsek indicated the object was converging on the helicopter at the same altitude at a airspeed in excess of 600 knots and on a midair collision heading. Cpt Coyne observed the converging object, took over the controls of the aircraft and initiated a power descent from 2500 feet to 1700 feet to avoid impact with the object. A radio call was initiated to Mansfield Tower who acknowledged the helicopter and was asked by CPT Coyne if there were any high performance aircraft flying in the vicinity of Mansfield Airport however there was no response received from the tower. The crew expected impact from the object instead, the object was observed to hesitate momentarily over the helicopter and then slowly continued on a westerly course accelerating at a high rate of speed, clear west of Mansfield Airport then turn 45 degree heading to the Northwest. Cpt Coyne indicated the altimeter read a 1000 fpm climb and read 3500 feet with the collective in the full down position. The aircraft was returned to 2500 feet by CPT Coyne and flown back to Cleveland, Ohio. The Flight plan was closed and the FAA Flight Service Station notified of the incident. The FSS told CPT Coyne to report the incident to the FAA GADO office at Cleveland Hopkins Airport. Mr. Porter, 83d USARCOM was notified of the incident at 1530 hours on 19 Oct 73.

3. This report has been read and attested to by the crewmembers of the aircraft with signatures acknowledging this report.

Robert Yanacsek

Arrigo D. Jozzi

Lawrence J. Coyne

John Healey

THE FIRST WRITTEN PUBLICITY OF THE EVENT

THE PLAIN DEALER, SUNDAY, OCTOBER 21, 1973



Sketch of the unidentified flying object that almost collided with an Army helicopter, was drawn by Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne. He describes the shaded area in front of the craft as a "glowing red light." A light ray at the rear of the craft gave off a green glow.

Copter narrowly misses collision with strange craft

By John P. Coyne

A crew of four aboard an Army helicopter en route to Cleveland narrowly missed a midair collision with an object described as "unlike anything produced on earth," it was revealed yesterday.

Military and federal aviation officials are puzzled over the incident.

The occurrence involving experienced aviators, comes in the midst of a growing number of reports in recent weeks of unidentified flying objects.

An Army captain and three reservists aboard a Huey helicopter said the unusual event happened Thursday night as they were returning from a flight to Columbus, where they had gone for physicals.

Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne, 36, who told the story to Federal Aviation Administration officials, is commander of the 316th Medivac unit based at Cleveland Hopkins International Airport.

He said his craft was flying at 2,500 feet about 10 miles east of Mansfield when the crew chief, Spec. 5 Robert J. Yanacsek, 23, reported a red light about five miles to the east. At first, the crew thought it was a radio beacon.

Seconds later, Yanacsek yelled, "The light is moving. It's coming at us. It's on a collision course."

Coyne, a veteran of 19 years of military flying, grabbed the controls from his copilot, Lt. Arriggo D. Jezzi, 26, of Sandusky.

"It looked like a fighter plane coming straight for us," Coyne said. "I took immediate evasive action. I cut the power and dropped into a shallow dive."

"We dropped through 2,000 feet, and it was headed right for us. We braced for impact."

Coyne said when the helicopter reached 1,500 feet, the approaching craft appeared to stop momentarily about 50 feet above the helicopter and banked to one side.

"We never saw anything like it before," Coyne said. "It was unreal. It was unlike anything produced on earth—a cigar-shaped craft with a glowing steady red light on its leading edge. A hull was at the very top of it and a green light emitted from the rear of the craft filled out the cabin with a green glow. It was eerie."

Coyne said the strange craft hovered over the helicopter only a few seconds. He glanced at the altimeter and noticed the helicopter had risen from 1,500 feet to 2,000 feet, although none of the crew members felt the gravitational pull normally felt when a helicopter rises.

"We felt a bounce, and then the other craft took off to the northeast," Coyne said. Seconds later, the craft disappeared.

The helicopter crew, by now fearful, tried to radio Mansfield Airport, but got no response. The unusual communications blackout lasted about 10 minutes until they finally got through to Akron-Canton Airport.

The story told to Coyne was verified by the other members of the four-man crew. Each of the men described the incident as unlike any experience he has had.

Coyne, who previously had steadfastly believed that all UFO sightings could be explained, found no rational explanation for this sighting.

S. Sgt. John M. Healey, a detective in the Cleveland police intelligence unit in civilian life, also was unable to explain the craft.

Judging from its quick appearance and disappearance, the crew members determined the speed of the unidentified craft was more than 600 miles an hour.

Coyne, a second cousin of this reporter, explained that a conventional jet flying this fast would create a vortex of airwaves that would be felt in the helicopter. But no waves were felt.

He added that a jet would create a great deal of noise flying that close to the helicopter, but no noises were heard.

Coyne said officials of the FAA told him to warn other pilots under his command about such an encounter. He said he would instruct his pilots to avoid panicking if they meet with the strange craft again.

NEWS JOURNAL

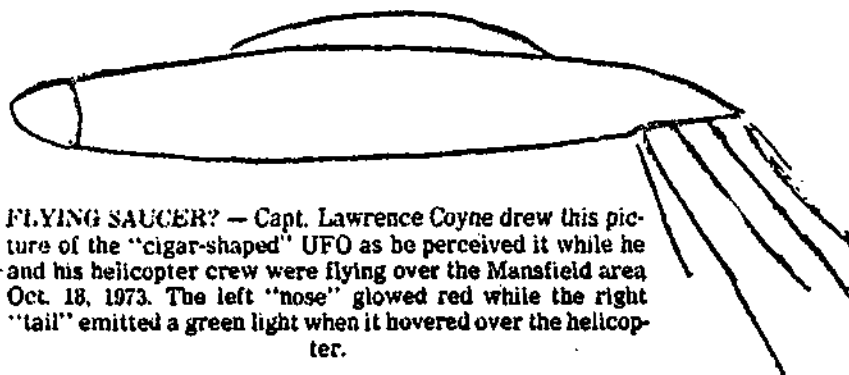
North Central Ohio's Foremost Newspaper

9) 522-3311

★

Mansfield, Ohio, Thursday, August 19, 1976

United Press International, Associated
Washington Post, Los Angeles Times



FLYING SAUCER? — Capt. Lawrence Coyne drew this picture of the "cigar-shaped" UFO as he perceived it while he and his helicopter crew were flying over the Mansfield area Oct. 18, 1973. The left "nose" glowed red while the right "tail" emitted a green light when it hovered over the helicopter.

UFO Investigations Reopened for Area

By Ann Gross

Closing in rapidly, the red light appeared to be headed on a collision course with the helicopter as it flew over the Mansfield area.

The captain grabbed the controls, put the aircraft in a shallow dive and braced himself for impact. What had at first appeared to be the red light of a radio tower now appeared as a cigar-shaped object "unlike anything produced on earth."

"It was unreal . . . with a glowing steady red light on its leading edge. A hull was at the very top of it, and a green light emitted from the rear of the craft filled our cabin with a green glow," the captain later described.

The helicopter was taken from an altitude of 2,500 feet to 1,700 feet to avoid impact with the object. Meanwhile, a radio call was initiated to the Mansfield-Lahn Airport tower. The helicopter received acknowledgement but when the captain asked if there were any high-performance aircraft flying in the vicinity of the Mansfield airport, there was no response from the tower.

The object hesitated momentarily over the helicopter and then slowly continued on a westerly course. It accelerated at a high rate of speed, west of the Mansfield airport, then turned and headed to the northwest, according to the official report by the captain and crew.

When the captain looked back at his altimeter, it indicated a 1,000-foot climb and read 3,500 feet even though the controls were in the full down position.

★ ★ ★

This incident took place over the Mansfield area at about 11:05 p.m., Oct. 18, 1973. Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne, then a veteran of 19 years in military flying, was pilot-in-command. His crew consisted of 1st Lt. Arrigo Jezzi, co-pilot; Robert Yanacsek, crew chief, and John Healey, flight medic. They were flying a National Guard helicopter from Columbus, headed for Cleveland-Hopkins Airport.

But the incident has not merely been recorded and forgotten. Warren B. Nicholson, director of the Civil Commission on Aerial Phenomena (CCAP), based in Worthington, is looking for ground witnesses to the helicopter incident that evening. He is also interested in reports of other UFO (unidentified flying object) sightings in Ohio, but still particularly in incidents which relate to the fall of 1973 when there was a rash of UFO sightings across the U.S.

APPENDIX C

Reported Pentagon Interest in Unusual Dreams of UFO Percipients

Coyne told me that approximately three weeks after the event he received a call from a man who identified himself as being from the "Department of the Army, Surgeon General's Office." Coyne says he does not remember the caller's name, rank, or where to contact him. The caller said he was in the field of metaphysics, and specifically asked if Coyne or any of the other crew members had had any unusual dreams since the UFO experience. Coyne, indeed, reported that he had had two unusual dreams; the first one, which he believed occurred two or three days after the event, he described as follows:

I was sleeping peacefully, and I got up and walked into the hallway and stopped, and I turned around and I saw myself lying in bed; I was laying on my side, sleeping. It was like looking into a mirror, you know? I dreamed that I was conscious but that my body was sleeping. I got up--I dreamed I was getting up--and I started walking, and I turned around--and I was scared--I saw something laying in bed, and it was me [laughs uneasily] and I got so scared that I lay back down again and I said, "I better do this over again." You know, am I seeing something? Am I hallucinating? And I laid back down and then I woke up. When I lay back down it was like sinking into something.

The other dream, which was very vivid--and I talked to my wife for a week about this--was, a voice said, "The answer is in the circle." A very clear voice. I don't know whose voice it was. It was a very strong voice, a voice you have respect for, very sure. It said, "The answer is in the circle." And I was holding a clear sphere in my hand, a round sphere. A bluish-

white sphere. This dream happened about two days later [after the first dream] and suddenly I started getting a little ridiculous and I told my wife about it and she said, "You're becoming a little absurd, you know."

Healey's discussion of the same subject is taken from a tape he made with his cousin Laura Gallagher, who was a student of Dr. Hynek's at Northwestern University. Healey said:

The Pentagon notified us we could talk about it, as long as we didn't lie about it. We could tell anybody that asked us what had happened. There was no classifying it. But as time would go by, the Pentagon would call us up and ask us, well, has this incident happened to you since the occurrence? And in two of the instances that I recall that they questioned me, was, number one, have I ever dreamed of body separation, and I have--I dreamed that I was dead in bed and that my spirit or whatever was floating, looking down at me lying dead in bed, and the only thing that upset me was I was wondering what would happen to my two boys, but other than that I had no qualms about it--and the other thing [that the Pentagon asked] was if I had ever dreamed of anything in spherical shape. Which definitely had not occurred to me. But every now and again the Pentagon--they haven't done it now for the past year, I guess, but every two months or so they'd call Larry, and they'd have a series of questions: had these certain incidents happened to you or had you dreamed of them since your incident with the UFO? And please contact the other people on the crew. And then Larry would call us up and ask about these things and then he would mail it back to the Pentagon. The Pentagon, from the way I gather it, believes us. . . .

Neither Jezzi or Yanacsek reported unusual dreams.

APPENDIX D

On November 27, 1978, Lt. Col. L.J. Coyne made this statement to the Special Political Committee of the United Nations as an accompaniment to a resolution introduced by Sir Eric Gairy, Prime Minister of Grenada, urging that the Secretary General of the United Nations appoint a three-member commission to coordinate the study of unidentified flying objects.

Mr. Chairman:

I have been asked here to present to this Committee an incident that occurred on October 18, 1973 involving a U.S. Army utility helicopter with a crew of four men in which I was Pilot in Command, and an Unidentified Flying Object. What separates this incident from many other UFO encounters is this particular incident almost resulted in a mid-air collision between a helicopter and a UFO.

Our helicopter departed Columbus, Ohio, USA on Thursday at 22.30 hours on 18 October 1973 for Cleveland, Ohio. The weather this particular night was clear with visibility 15 miles or better, no clouds, and winds less than 10 knots. The crew of the helicopter consisted of four men: one crew chief, one flight medic, a co-pilot, and myself as pilot in command. With a flight plan filed with Flight Service, we departed Columbus, Ohio without incident which seemed to be a routine flight, one that I have made many times before. We climbed and leveled off at an altitude of 2500 feet msl on a heading of 030 degrees, maintaining an airspeed of 90 knots. Once we cleared the terminal control area of Columbus, Ohio, I turned the controls over to 1st Lt. Jezzi, co-pilot of the aircraft, and relaxed to enjoy the flight to Cleveland, Ohio. After 30 minutes into the flight, our helicopter approached the vicinity of Mansfield, Ohio, which would pass to the west of the helicopter.

I then tuned and identified the non-direction beacon located to the southeast of this city for position identification. It was at this time that Sgt. Healey, the flight medic, noticed an aircraft with a bright red light moving south, positioned west of our helicopter. The sergeant commented on the craft, its direction and position over the intercom system. There was no threat or unusual circumstances noted at this time. Minutes later, the crew chief, Staff Sgt. Yanacsek, noted a bright red light on the horizon east of the helicopter and reported the position over the intercom. I advised him to further observe the red light's movements. Several minutes later Sgt. Yanacsek reported the red light on the east horizon was parallel in direction and speed with our helicopter. I again advised further observation to Sgt. Yanacsek on the red light. Several minutes after that, Sgt. Yanacsek reported that the red-lighted aircraft had now changed its heading and now was approaching our helicopter on a perpendicular course at a very high rate of speed (in excess of 600 knots). At that moment I looked to my right on the east horizon and observed a steady bright red light converging at a high rate of speed perpendicular towards the helicopter. I immediately contacted Mansfield Approach Control on the VHF radio, giving our aircraft identification and asked if any high performance aircraft were in the area. Mansfield Approach Control acknowledged our aircraft call sign and asked the question "Go ahead," requiring me to repeat the question on high performance aircraft location. At that point no further acknowledgement was received. The aircraft radios still keyed when depressed and channel tones were heard when frequency changes were made. I notified the co-pilot that I was assuming command of the aircraft controls and asked him to try to reach Mansfield Approach on the other radios. With the aircraft under my control, I observed the red-lighted object closing upon the helicopter at the same altitude at a high rate of speed. It became

apparent a mid-air collision was about to happen unless evasive action was taken.

I initiated a descent from 2500 feet with a 500 foot per minute descent, however noticing that the red-lighted object also descended with the helicopter while maintaining its collision course. I then increased the helicopter descent to 1000 feet per minute to avoid collision; however, the red-lighted object also descended on a collision course. I then increased the descent to 2000 feet per minute and increased airspeed from 90 to 100 knots, and since visibility was clear that night, I selected a field site for an emergency landing, if needed. The evasive action proved futile because the object was just upon the helicopter on its collision course. I then cursed to myself and told the crew on intercom to brace for impact. The anticipated moment of impact never happened. I closed my eyes momentarily, but this was interrupted by the flight medic stating over the intercom, "Look at that!" With that statement, I looked out ahead of the helicopter and observed an aircraft I have never seen before.

This craft positioned itself directly in front of the moving helicopter. This craft was 50 to 60 feet long with a grey metallic structure. On the front of this craft was a large steady bright red light. I could delineate where the red stopped on the structure of this craft because red was reflecting off the grey structure. The design of this craft was symmetrical in shape with a prominent aft indentation on the undercarriage.

From this portion of the undercarriage, a green light, pyramid-shaped, emerged with the light initially in the trail position. This green light then swung 90 degrees, coming directly into the front windshield and lighting up the entire cockpit of the aircraft. All colors inside the

cabin of the helicopter were absorbed by this green light. That includes the instrument panel lights on the aircraft.

I should like to inject one point at this time and that is at the time that I increased the helicopter descent to 2000 fpm, while selecting a field site for an emergency landing, I noticed the altimeter reading was passing through 1700 feet and the ground was coming up fast. Trying to recall time in terms of minutes or seconds at the point of interception with this object was ridiculous at this portion of the incident.

With the green light inside the cabin of the aircraft still coming directly from the object positioned in front of my moving helicopter, I noticed the magnetic compass on the aircraft instrument panel was slowly but steadily spinning. It no longer held a constant heading but instead continued to slowly spin.

Lt. Jezzi, the co-pilot, related to me that the radios were no longer functioning; I however told him keying tones and channel tones were still audible and to go to emergency frequency. He followed my orders; however, there still was no communication established. I then looked at the altimeter on the instrument panel and was surprised to see the helicopter's altitude now was 3000 feet and climbing 1000 feet per minute as indicated on the vertical velocity indicator. I had not during any time to my recollection increased power from a 2000 foot per minute descent to a 1000 foot per minute climb. I looked outside to the ground and could see that the helicopter was in fact climbing and rechecked myself to see if I had moved any controls.

Mr. Chairman and members of this committee, there was no change in the controls or power setting. They were still set for a 2000 foot per minute descent, even though the helicopter was climbing a 1000 feet per minute with the object still positioned in front of the aircraft and the

green light still on the helicopter. I did not apply any power changes to the helicopter until the altimeter read 3500 feet.

At 3800 feet a bump was felt. At no other time during this incident was any noise other than from the helicopter heard nor any turbulence felt by all members of this crew. The UFO then moved away to the west slowly from the helicopter, the green light from the UFO retracted with the helicopter settling to a descent. The object momentarily was over the helicopter and could be observed through the top plexiglas which is green in color.

It was at this point that a bright white light from the object was noticed. Lt. Jezzi, the co-pilot, commented that the light was brighter than that of a landing light on a commercial airliner. As the object's distance increased away from the helicopter, the light from the object became even brighter and the object was now visible through the co-pilot's left door plexiglas. As the light grew brighter, a noticeable increase in speed was observed. The object flew westbound between the city of Mansfield and Mansfield Airport, then turning northwest, increasing at even a higher rate of speed, and disappearing. At this point, the radios became alive with chatter and communication was established over the city of Ashland, Ohio, with a position fix from Akron Approach Control.

Another point to inject here is to finalize the description of this object. No noticeable wings or landing gears were observed. No vertical or horizontal stabilizers were observed. This object demonstrated its ability to change or maintain altitude headings and speed control.

As a result of my experience, I am convinced this object was real and that these types of incidents should require a thorough investigation. It is my own personal opinion that worldwide procedures need to be established to effec-

tively study this phenomena through an international cooperative effort. The establishment of a Transponder Code for aircraft flying worldwide is needed, to identify to ground controllers that a pilot is indeed experiencing a UFO phenomena and that pilot anxiety can be reduced to provide safe effective flying, knowing he is under radar control.

I wish to thank you Mr. Chairman, and the delegation from the country of Grenada, for allowing me to present my report to this Committee.

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